

Lightning Path

Workbook Three

LP Connection Framework

Version 1.01

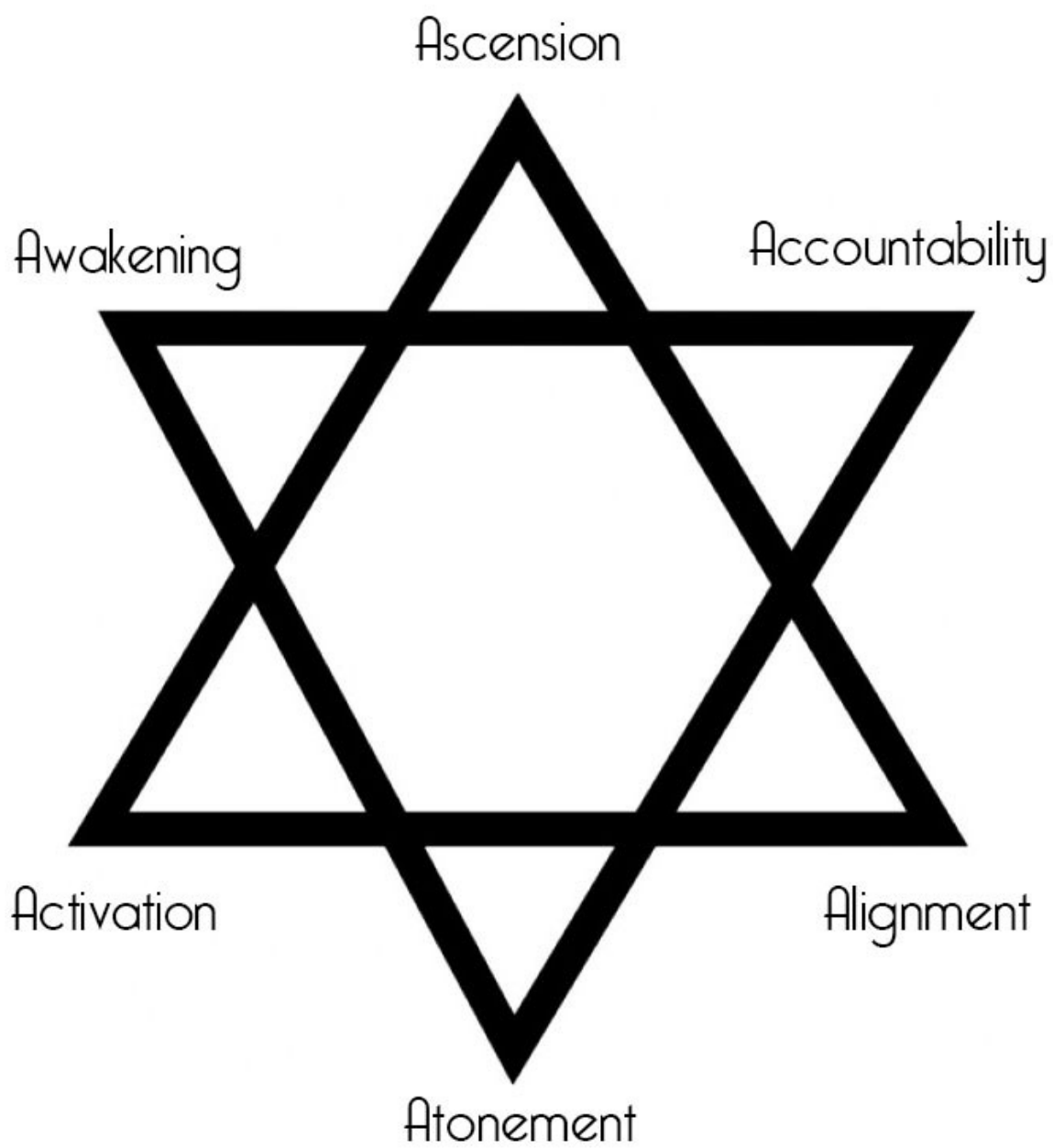
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As I have gained knowledge and seen others share their visions with me, I conclude that our ancestors lived in a strange condition in which they were in touch with the spirits constantly, and I see that as a goal for our present activities.

Vine Deloria - God is Read

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Preface

Greetings and welcome to the Lightning Path (or just LP for short). The Lightning Path is a modern and Human Development Framework that blends [Authentic Spirituality](http://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Authentic_Spirituality)¹ and connected science into a powerful representation of core human and spiritual truths designed to take you from disconnected and depressed to healthy, connected, and empowered, quickly and safely.

Recognizing that the elites, the [Accumulating Class](https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Accumulating_Class),² those who create the realities of this world to favour themselves, have been interfering in our understanding and practice of spirituality for thousands of years, the Lightning Path offers a decolonized spiritual perspective and practice. It strips elite influence from the corpus and provides a grass-roots spirituality rooted in mystical, religious, and transcendent experiences through a refined and a critical scientific lens.

The workbook that you have in your hand is Book Three in the Lightning Path Workbook series. This book is preceded by *Lightning Path Workbook One: Introduction to Authentic Spirituality*, and *Lightning Path*. This book covers spiritual concepts designed to help you expand your knowledge and understanding of what connection is and why it is important to you. The book also covers spiritual techniques which you can use to prepare and work towards stronger *connection* to your individual spiritual ego, and to Consciousness more generally.

Note, there is a lot of information and material contained in this and previous Lightning Path workbooks. It will take time to process,

¹http://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Authentic_Spirituality

²https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Accumulating_Class

integrate, and ground the information into your reality. If you want to derive full benefit from the information provided here, be prepared to read through this workbook more than once. Also, if you have not read LP Workbook One and Two, make sure you do so before proceeding. Otherwise you may struggle with the concepts and guidance provided in this workbook.

Workbook Goals

At the end of this book, you will:

- Understand the nature of Connection between the Spiritual Ego and Bodily Ego, and understand what you have to do to prepare and work towards achieving sustained connection.
- Understand the six points of the Lightning Path Connection Framework and be able to use that framework to guide your own healing and connection work.
- Recognize Awareness Reduction Mechanisms (ARMs) and other obstacles that might prevent you from making solid progress on awakening, alignment, accountability, atonement, activation, and ascension.
- Begin developing and putting into practice several basic spiritual practices including intent, visualization, and deep breathing, which can help you achieve and handle stronger connection experiences.

Key Concepts

By the end of this book, you should be familiar with the following LP concepts.

- Accountability
- Activation
- Alignment / Alignment Rule Sets
- Ascension
- Atonement
- Automobile Metaphor
- Awakening
- Awakening Affirmation
- Awakening Experience
- Alignment
- Awareness Reduction Mechanisms
- Alignment Rule Set
- Awakening Mantras
- Bodily Ego
- Boundary Violation
- Breathing
- Connection
- Connection Appliance
- Connection Cocoon
- Connection Event/Connection Experience
- Connection Pathology
- Connection Practice
- Connection Preparation
- Connection Procedures
- Connection Processing

- Connection Supplements
- Connection Technique
- Consciousness
- Consistent and persistent intent
- Disjuncture
- Egoic Bloating / Ego Explosion
- Emotional Semaphore
- Flow, The
- Flow Control
- Flow Purification
- Focus Points
- Intent/Will
- Internal Resistance/External Resistance
- Learned Helplessness
- Maladaptive Adaptation
- Nadir Experiences/Zenith Experiences
- Normal Consciousness
- Old Energy / New Energy
- Old Energy archetypes
- Psychic Infection
- Punishment
- Recognize, Root out, Replace
- Right Action, Right Environment, Right Thought
- Spiritual Ego
- Steering Emotions
- Three “Rs” of Alignment
- Three “Ws” of Alignment
- Toxic Socialization
- Wrong Action, Wrong Environment, Wrong Thought
- Water Glass Visualization

Introduction

Greetings and welcome to the third workbook in the LP Workbook series. Before proceeding with this workbook, you should know the basic LP concepts like Spiritual Ego, Bodily Ego, Physical Unit, Highest Self, Connection, Connection Experience, and Toxic Socialization. You should also have considered your need to heal from the damage done by Toxic Socialization. Hopefully, at this point, you have also put into practice some of the many suggestions provided in the LP workbook on HEALING, like creating a healthy environment, dealing with your addictions, fulfilling some of your unmet needs, and so on. You certainly do not have to be shiny and unsullied at this point, but it is wise to be actively involved in the process of creating a healthier you.

Beyond making progress on your healing journey, you should also have a good idea about what spiritual awakening and connection is, what its benefits are, how to initiate it (i.e. intent), and how to anticipate some of the traps and pitfalls (i.e. **Internal Resistance** and **External Resistance**) that may slow or even halt your progress forward. It is important to understand that while making a connection is relatively easy, especially if you use **Connection Supplements**,³ handling a connection can be quite a challenge, especially if there is underlying psychological and emotional damage, and particularly if you harbour significant [Wrong Thought](#).

If you are not comfortable that you have made progress on your HEALING journey, and if you are not confident you understand the

³A connection supplement is a dietary supplement (like Cannabis, Psilocybin, Peyote) or substance (like DMT, LSD, Ketamine, MDMA, etc.) that forces and facilitates stronger Connection to Consciousness.

basics outlined above, review the first two LP workbooks before proceeding with this book.⁴

If you are comfortable that you are ready to move forward, then great. In this course, we are going to go into a little bit more detail about what you need to do to attain a stronger, more persistent connection to your [Spiritual Ego](#).⁵ Specifically, we are going to introduce you to the LP Connection Framework. The LP Connection Framework is a framework that provides you with six [Focus Points](#). These focus points provide guidance on where you should put your effort and attention if you want to make progress towards stronger and more persistent connection between your spiritual ego and your bodily ego. The six focus points are *awakening*, *accountability*, *atonement*, *activation*, *alignment*, and *ascension*. Briefly,

1. **Awakening** is the process of seeing, realizing, and understanding the reality you live as it is—accurately. Specifically. Awakening involves understanding the personal, social, political, economic, and even cosmic/theological truths that inform your life.
2. **Accountability** is the process of accepting the fact that things are not as great as they seem and that you may have done some bad things in your life, like using violence to socialize children, treating your spouse like dirt, exploiting employees to enrich yourself, etc.. Accountability is taking responsibility and being accountable for any toxic actions you have taken, consciously or unconsciously, past or in the present.

⁴<https://repo.lightningpath.org/assets/workbooks/>

⁵https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Spiritual_Ego

3. **Atonement** is an extension of accountability. Atonement is the process of making reparation for the harm you have caused. This does not mean lip service, bandage solutions, or charity work. This means fundamental revolution and reform in your life spaces and in your behaviours towards others (spouse, children, co-workers, employees, citizens, etc.). Atonement requires helping and supporting others. It means being an advocate and an ally, particularly for those whom you have disadvantaged as a consequence of your own behaviours.
4. **Alignment** is the process of using your creative power and ability to bring your thoughts, actions, and environments into correspondence (i.e. alignment) with the nature and wishes of your own spiritual ego.
5. **Activation** is the process of embracing your creative power to become an empowered change agent in the world. Activation is a psychological and energetic process.
6. **Ascension** is the actual process of merging your bodily ego with your spiritual ego, of becoming more of who you truly are deep inside. Although brief connection experiences are always possible, pure and persistent union, which is the point of spiritual practice, can only occur after awakening, accountability, atonement, alignment, and activation have been achieved. It *cannot* occur without those.

We will go into more detail about these focus points in the associated chapters. Before moving forward, there are three things to keep in mind.

The **first thing** to keep in mind is that the work you do on healing and

connection is not linear, but iterative. *Visualize the process of healing and connection like climbing a spiral out of the sickness and toxicity of disconnection.* The more you climb up, the farther away you get from the toxicity and trauma of the “normal” world and the closer you get to your own inner light and power. You might start with a single healing step, like addressing your toxic environment, but you will not end there. For best effect, you will jump back and forth, doing a little healing work, then a little connection work, and then back to healing, and so on. There are no rules on what step to take first and what step to take next. For best effect, follow your own intuition.

The **second thing** to keep in mind is that there is a practical component to all this. You can understand the ideas conveyed in this and other courses all you want, but if you do not engage in the practices suggested, you will not move forward as expected. This might sound bold, but it is really quite simple. If you want to learn guitar, you can read about music and look at chord diagrams all you want, but if you do not pick up a guitar and practice, it is an academic exercise. It is the same with connection. Read all the theory and guidance you want, but if you do not actually practice connection, you will never advance towards it.

Finally, never, ever, ever think that you have to follow this path alone. Although you might start off alone, that will change, perhaps more rapidly than you might think. As more and more people step on an authentic path of healing and connection, more and more the road we travel will be populated by our fellows, those new on the path and those who are already seasoned travellers. Be patient and be hopeful. The more people travel an authentic path of healing and connection, the faster we will transform not only ourselves, but the entire planet.

With that said, let us begin our examination of the Lightning Path Connection Framework by looking at the first focus point, awakening.

Awakening

The first focus point in the LP Connection Framework, the first thing that you have to do when you begin your connection process, is engage in a bit of authentic spiritual awakening. In *LP Workbook One* you learned that spiritual awakening involves drawing Consciousness into the physical unit, and so that is what you have to do. You have to draw some of your higher Consciousness into your physical vehicle.

The LP conceives of spiritual awakening like walking into a dark room and turning on a light, or waking up from a deep sleep and throwing open the window blind to observe the room you are in. When you walk into a dark room, at first you cannot see anything. Then, when you add light, suddenly you see the whole room.

Waking up is not necessarily a pleasant experience. What your experience is and how you feel about things depends on your own mental and emotional state and the condition of the room. If the room is clean and shiny and your mental state is grounded and clear, your awakening will be pleasant. However, if the room is messy with abuse, violence, exploitation, neglect, chaos, and indoctrination of toxic socialization, and if your mental and emotional states are damaged, ungrounded, clouded, and fragile, your awakening experience may be quite unpleasant, especially as you realize the damage that has been done and the amount of work that might be involved in cleaning up the messes.

Now that you know what you might expect when you initiate your spiritual awakening, the next question is how do you wake up. You wake up spiritually the same way you wake up in the morning. It is simply a question of intent. To wake in the morning, you intend to

wake up. You decide you are going to wake up, set your (internal or external alarm clock) and when the time comes you do it. It is that simple. It is the same with spiritual awakening. You signal your wilful intent to wake up with an [Awakening Affirmation](#) (see examples below or on the SpiritWiki) and when the time comes, you do it.

Awakening Affirmation

- I wish to wake up
- I wish to gain enlightenment
- I wish consciousness to descend into the vessel.
- I wish to move forward as fast and as *safely* as possible.
- I wish *only* the highest information for *greatest collective good* of all of creation.

As you can see, initiating spiritual awakening is simple. However, the experience may not be. It can be very positive, that is true; but awakening can also cause a lot of emotional and psychological distress as well.

, especially when combined with a powerful [Connection Experience](#).⁶

In some cases, where there is a lot of damage and trauma to the [Bodily Ego](#),⁷ if there is lots of repressed guilt and shame, if there are addiction and mental health issues—in other words if the room is quite messy—awakening can be extremely challenging. You can experience guilt, shame, disjuncture, anxiety, and more. You can have what we call

⁶ See https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Connection_Experience.

⁷https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Bodily_Ego

[Nadir Experiences](#),⁸ negative mystical experiences. In very rare cases, awakening can even tip you over the edge into despair, neurosis, “spiritual emergency,”⁹ and even paranoid psychosis. Remember the advice from workbook one. If you find yourself struggling, seek professional help.

Whether you experience awakening in a positive or negative fashion depends entirely on two things:

1. The condition of “the room” you are waking up in and
2. your own mental and emotional condition

Let us look in a bit more detail at these two factors in turn, starting with the condition of the room.

Room Condition

As regards the condition of the room, the best situation to wake up in is when the room is ordered, clean, and tidy. Awakening in a clean and tidy reality in a healthy environment with minimal toxicity, abuse, ideology, resistance, neurosis, and pathology. When the room of your life is ordered, clean, calm, free of toxicity, chaos, and violence, awakening proceeds in a fluid and easy-to-ground and integrate fashion. If, on the other hand, the room you are waking up in is a

⁸A nadir experience is a negatively felt connection experience. Nadir experiences are unpleasant moments of stress, anxiety, anger, confusion, fear, paranoia, and even psychosis caused when [Connection](#) occurs and the individual is unprepared, damaged, embedded in a toxic milieu, or filled with ideologically rooted wrong thought. A Nadir experience is the opposite of a [Zenith Experience](#).

See http://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Nadir_Experience and http://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Zenith_Experience

⁹Stanislav Grof and Christina Grof, *Spiritual Emergency: When Personal Transformation Becomes a Crisis* (New York: Putnam, 1989), <https://amzn.to/2KbTh6s>.

mess, if there is considerable violence, toxicity, enmeshment, resistance, ideology, and pathology, things can get a little complicated. You can become frightened, confused, shocked, overwhelmed with guilt and shame, and traumatized to the point of mental and emotional breakdown. If that happens, you may be so put off by the experience that you may decide to “go back to sleep,” that is, return to the [Normal Consciousness](#)¹⁰ of your average, disconnected modern citizen and never try connection again. And that would be too bad.

If you want to avoid being pushed back into the washed-out grey somnambulism of normal consciousness, there are three things to watch out for:

1. Internal Resistance
2. External Resistance and
3. The Enormity of the Mess

Internal Resistance

Number one, watch out for **internal resistance**. Internal resistance is resistance to awakening caused by the confusion, guilt, shame, etc. that are triggered by what you see when the light in your head suddenly goes on.

Maybe you are a parent and you suddenly “see” you’ve been abusing your children.

Maybe your brother (kid’s Uncle) is a pedophile who is abusing family children.

Maybe you are the CEO of a major corporation enriching yourself

¹⁰https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Normal_Consciousness

through economic predation.

Maybe you are a lying, greedy politician.

If you are any of these things, and many things I won't bother to mention, then waking up can be a very unpleasant experience. This is especially true if you have done lots of things to be guilty and ashamed of. If you've done lots to be guilty and ashamed of then when the light goes in in your brain, you are going to experience an ocean of guilt and shame. In that case, your choices are three. Self-destruction, self-delusion, or just face whatever you've done.

I recommend option three.

Face whatever you have done and acknowledge it. For sure feel bad for what you've done. Feel the guilt and shame. That's the point of feeling, good or bad. Feelings are **Steering Emotions**¹¹ that tell you when you're right and wrong.

But don't feel too bad.

Don't beat yourself up, don't get drunk to forget, and for God's sake don't kill yourself.

¹¹Guilt and shame are what we might call Steering Emotions. They are part of an evolved system of **Emotional Semaphore** that your spiritual ego uses to try and "steer the ship," so to speak, while the bodily ego is blind and asleep. Emotions like guilt, shame, joy, and even satisfaction are design features of the physical unit designed to facilitate alignment. Positive steering emotions of happiness, joy, and contentment tell you that you are "on the right path," i.e., the path towards alignment and connection. On the other hand, negative steering emotions of guilt, shame, and fear tell you that you are on the "wrong path," that you are thinking or doing things that are out of alignment with your spiritual ego.

Because steering emotions guide you towards alignment and connection, steering emotions, even negative ones, are functional and healthy. They give you actionable information on how to change your behaviour, and you should definitely change your behaviour. Do not do what makes you feel guilt and shame. Do what makes you feel good (so long as you cause no harm). If you feel guilty because you are screaming at your children, or shame because you are exploiting your employees, take responsibility for your actions and stop, period. When you do that, the painful negative feelings of guilt and shame begin to go away and you take a step forward towards easier and more persistent connection.

Instead, *forgive yourself* no matter what.

What good is harming yourself going to do?

Nothing!

It's a complete waste of energy. And besides, we all grew up in a toxic shit-pile, we've all done what we needed to survive it, and we've all done things we're not proud of.

And besides...

Forgiving yourself (and forgiving others) is the best option and really the only way forward, individually and collectively. It's the first step towards clearing your shame and the first step towards full reconnection (step two, next unit).

To overcome internal resistance, just face what you've done and forgive yourself. We'll talk about what you can do to make for it in our third lesson on atonement.

External Resistance

In addition to your own internal resistance, you also need to watch out for **External Resistance**. External resistance is resistance from family, friends, co-workers, and others who are still sleeping and who, for various reasons associated with *their own internal resistance*, do not want to be presented with what *you* have suddenly become aware of. Predators, family pedophiles and abusers, murders, corporate thieves and exploiters of all stripes all have a lot to feel bad about, and to fear, frankly. Guilt and shame are painful emotions and nobody wants to feel them, so they repress and avoid. The burden of guilt and shame builds to the point that opening the door is like bursting a dam. There's

enough water held back to devastate even the strongest.

And if that's not bad enough, there's punishment. Our entire globe is focused on harming others (euphemized as punishment) every time they do something "wrong." It starts in infancy and doesn't end until we're dead. By the time we enter adulthood we've been "punished" so many times we've lost count. It's perverse. It damages us and it teaches us to be defensive. Punishment is toxic. It doesn't improve us. It doesn't make us strong. It damages our bodies and minds and it teaches us to not be open and honest about our **Misaligned Behaviour**. It teaches us not to talk and empathize and resolve but to hide and justify and excuse. As adults, we're all terrified of the punishments that might ensue if the people really knew and so we whenever our own behaviour is externally challenged, we get defensive.

So how do you deal with this? Really, the only way to resolve external resistance caused by past bad behaviour is to forgive it all, clean slate for everyone, starting ASAP. IF we can do that then everybody can calm down and quit being so defensive and we can all sit down and talk it out. Until there is a collective and global amnesty, change is gonna be super slow. Until then, if people resist your own awakening, try and calm them down. If you can't, get on with your own work and avoid triggering their guilt and shame as best you can. It is important you don't let external resistance stop you. Global Amnesty will become automatic when enough people step through this door. Add yourself to the count.

Now, don't get me wrong here. Forgiving someone does not mean we don't hold people accountable. As we will see as we move through this workbook, it does not mean we don't expect them to atone. It just means we promise not to punish. That's all.

The Overwhelming Enormity of the Mess

Internal and external resistance are big deals, but they are not the only things that can shut down awakening. It is also true that at a certain point you are going to be overwhelmed by the enormity of the personal, familial, social, political, economic, and environmental mess and the cleanup that's involved.

I'm not gonna bother going into details here. You'll know when you get to this point.

When you do get to that point, take some deep breaths and relax.

There's lots of work to do, but you don't have to do it alone.

...

Mental and Emotional Damage

As noted, awakening can be a challenge when the room you are waking up in is a mess. In that case, you can experience internal resistance, external resistance, or you can simply become overwhelmed by the mess. All of this can make you want to hit the snooze button and go back to sleep.

Awakening can also be a challenge if you struggle with emotional and psychological damage caused by a violent, neglectful, and toxic socialization process we all endure. If you are mentally or emotionally damaged, and the truth is all of us experience some damage because of the toxic socialization process we endure, the process of awakening (indeed all points in the connection process, like atonement, activation, etc.) can become much more difficult. Let us spend a bit of time

examining some of the awakening challenges that can arise as a consequence of mental and emotional damage.

Low Self-esteem and Self-worth

In terms of obstacles to awakening, low-esteem can be a major problem. This is because low self-esteem and low self-worth undermine your progress by causing you to cast doubt on your own abilities to heal and grow into a healthy and fully connected human being. Low self-esteem may make you shy away from the process because you feel you are “not worthy” or incapable of succeeding in any way. These feelings may also lead you to accept abusive situations because you feel you do not deserve better, thereby leading to more damage. Low self-worth may even make other focus points in the connection framework harder to accomplish, like being accountable, or activating and taking action to align and clean up your world. Without a certain degree of self-esteem and self-worth, you might awaken and see a messy room, but not feel confident enough or strong enough to tackle the mess or go against the resistance of other people. As a result, you might go straight back to sleep.

You can use psychological tests to measure your self-esteem. The [Rosenberg Self-Esteem Scale](#) is a good one. Take the test and if you score less than 15 you may have self-esteem issues.

If you do find you are a little on the low side of the self-esteem scale, you can do an Internet search for “how to improve self-esteem.” These days there is lots of great guidance on how to improve self-esteem and self-worth. We also do a little bit of self-esteem work later on the **Lightning Path Curriculum** when we learn about existential narratives, examine this planet’s dominant existential narrative, and

explore how we untangle ourselves from it and heal from its devastating emotional and psychological impact.

Powerlessness, Depression, and Learned Helplessness

Low self-esteem caused by the damage of toxic socialization is not the only psychological issue that can undermine your ability to awaken to the realities around you. Years of living in toxic and oppressive home and work spaces that you have no control over may leave you feeling depressed, dis-empowered, demotivated, helpless, apathetic, and hopeless. You may come to feel and believe that nothing you do or say can make any difference at all, so what is the point of even trying.

Psychologists call this psychological state [Learned Helplessness](#).¹²

Learned helplessness, depression, and feelings of powerlessness can undermine your healing and connection process simply because when you are in a state of learned helplessness, you may not feel worthy of life improvements or motivated to make the necessary changes. You may be feeling impotent and powerless even in the face of relatively minor challenges. These feelings of impotence and helplessness will weigh on you and make it harder for you to take the actions necessary to move forward. Put that together with a lack of self-esteem and the guilt and shame that rises from unaligned actions (more on this in the next unit), and going back to sleep might seem like the best (and only) thing to do.

The LP provides an implementation of the [Learned Helplessness Scale](#) which you can use to assess the extent to which you have become learned helpless as a result of violence and toxicity in your life.

If you do think you may have learned to be helpless as a consequence

¹²https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Learned_Helplessness

of chronic toxicity, you can do an Internet search for “how to overcome learned helplessness.” A general guideline is to find a thing that you know you can do well and practice that. Mastery of skills, relationships, and so on can help you build self-esteem and self-efficacy. It will also help to work with the *Triumph of Spirit Archetype System* (TOSAS), which you will learn more about in *LP Workbook Four* and in our book *Rocket Scientists’ Guide to Neurodecolonization*. As a final note here, overcoming learned helplessness is very important. It is not enough to just wake up and see what is in the room. As you will see in subsequent units, you also have to take action to change. You are going to have a hard time taking action if you struggle with helplessness and lack of motivation.

Anger and Hatred

Low self-esteem and learned helplessness caused by toxicity in your childhood and adult environments can stop your awakening and connection process before it ever gets started, but so can anger and hatred. Of course, anger is not a bad thing in and of itself. Anger is a natural emotion. Anger is what your body uses to alert you to a [Boundary Violation](#).¹³ If I stand before you and step on your toes (a violation of your physical boundaries), if I insult you and call you names (a violation of your psychological and emotional boundaries), if I exploit you financially, you will naturally get angry. The anger helps motivate you to stop me, to shove me away from your feet. leave the room, or engage in transformative social action., and that is all completely healthy.

¹³A Boundary Violation is a form of [Violence](#) common in this planet's [Toxic Socialization](#) system. It occurs when one person violates another person's psychological, emotional, or spiritual boundaries in an aggressive, assaultive, manipulative, selfish, or otherwise unwelcome fashion
https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Boundary_Violation

However, often in our societies anger goes unexpressed, unreleased, or inappropriately expressed. For reasons we will not explore here, within this toxic socialization system we all endure, we are not taught healthy ways to deal with anger; instead, we are taught to **suppress** anger, to keep it inside, or to redirect it to scapegoats. If you do that, if you suppress it down or redirect it to inappropriate targets, the anger does not go away, it just becomes sublimated¹⁴ (i.e. redirected towards others) or internalized (directed back at you).¹⁵ Once sublimated or internalized, your anger becomes a controlling emotion and this emotion tainted your vision and blinds you to the things you need to see and the things you need to do as you awaken to the world around you.

As for hatred, hate is the consequence of years of sublimated, repressed, and misdirected anger. It is the outcome of years of bottled-up resentment at chronic, painful, and exploitative boundary violations. Hatred blinds you like anger, only worse. It also damaged your heart in ways that are difficult to repair.

A lot could be said about anger and hatred and how to deal with it, and there's lots of decent advice online on how to recognize, resolve, and release anger. If you have anger, we encourage you to find healthy ways to express and release it because if you don't, you'll find it impossible to heal and properly connect. In additional guidance to what

¹⁴ Sublimation is the redirection of energy and awareness from an appropriate target to an inappropriate target. For example, an adolescent angry at their father may, because the father will respond to their anger with more abuse, redirect their anger to weaker children at school, or their spouse at home.

<https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Sublimation>

¹⁵<https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Internalization>

you can find online, we'll only say to two things.

The first thing we want to say is make sure the solution you are trying isn't gas lighting you. Remember what we said at the outset, anger is a reasonable emotion. If you are angry about something, not only does that anger need to be appropriately expressed, but the "something" that you are mad about has to be dealt with. If the focus is just on you and how you deal with it, you're being gaslit. Put another way, you can release anger at your exploitative boss or oppressive teacher or boundary-violating friend all you like, but if you continue to experience assault, the anger returns. As you'll learn in more detail a bit later, if you want to deal with anger and hatred you have to deal in an appropriate and non-violent way with whatever is causing that anger to boil up. If you don't, the anger always returns.

The second thing we want to say is that when it comes to resolving your anger, make sure you've got the right source. The truth is, the anger inside us is generated from multiple sources over years and decades of life. Some of these sources we might not even remember. Our parents and siblings do lots of things to anger us growing up, as do our friends at school, our teachers, our priests, our intimate partners, our bosses, and so on. All that anger can build up and if suppressed or improperly resolved, can become sublimated and projected outwards. This projection usually travels "downhill," at targets that you have power over, like your children, or your spouse, or your employees, or even your pets. If you're taking your anger out on inappropriate targets, you're not resolving anger, you are abusing others, and that's just going to add to your connection troubles down the road. So make sure you have to right source. And don't worry. Identifying the source is not as hard as you think. If you are mad, focus not on the person per say, but

on the behaviour that is making you mad. For best results, identify what the behaviour is, ask yourself why that behaviour is making you mad, and focus on strategies to change the behaviours and the conditions that trigger that anger. Don't judge and punish the person. That's not helpful. If you focus on the behaviour and not the person you'll find it easier to understand your anger, easier to release that anger, and easier to trace that anger to its original source, which, frankly, is probably in how you were treated as a child, adolescent, and young adult. Express your anger at the behaviour, *not* the person, and find ways to change the behaviour and the environment.

Hitting the Snooze Button – Invoking ARMs

So far in this chapter, we have learned that authentic awakening is an important step in the reconnection process. Awakening means becoming fully (socially, politically, economically, emotionally, etc.) aware of the reality that you live in. We have also learned some of the things that can interfere with the awakening process. In particular, a messy room and emotional and psychological damage caused by toxic socialization can undermine and prevent authentic spiritual awakening in various ways. Messy rooms can lead to internal and external resistance and toxic socialization can leave you feeling helpless, hopeless, powerless, and filled with anger, hatred and mistrust to the point where it is simply too painful for you to stay awake and move forward.

So what do you do when you find it just too hard to move forward? Generally, you turn off the light and go back to sleep. How do you do that? Well, it is not like going back to sleep in the morning. You cannot

close your eyes and un-see the pedophile uncle. You cannot just forget you are exploiting workers or wish away childhood trauma. Instead, your bodily ego engages what traditional psychology will call defense mechanisms but what we on the LP call [Awareness Reduction Mechanisms](#) (ARMs). ARMs are psychological/behavioural methods deployed by the bodily ego to help deal with low self-esteem, low self-worth, powerlessness, depression, anger, hatred, mistrust, anxiety, anger, sadness, and other strong emotions caused by mental and emotional damage, the sometimes overwhelming nature of the situation, the recall of trauma, and the guilt and shame caused by disjuncture. Awareness reduction mechanisms help the bodily ego reduce awareness of internal states and external realities so that the bodily ego can return back a functioning state.

There are many Awareness Reduction Mechanisms that the bodily ego can use to reduce an awareness that has become painful. We will review a few of these below. For more, see the [associated SpiritWiki Page](#)¹⁶ and more advanced LP content.

- **Suppression** is the conscious, brute-force removal of unwanted ideas and feelings from your awareness. When you repress, you simply say to ourselves “I’m not going to think about that or feel about that at all.” We do this either because we do not want to deal with the thing at a particular moment (our spouse is behaving badly at a gathering but we “can’t deal with that now” so we push it aside till the guests leave) or we don’t want to deal with it at all (yes there’s a pedophile in the family, but I don’t want to think about that; it’s not my problem and what can about it anyway). With suppression, the ideas and feelings are

¹⁶https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Awareness_Reduction_Mechanisms

still there, we just push them away whenever they float up.

- [Repression](#)¹⁷ is the unconscious forgetting of painful memories. We repress memories either of our own actions towards others (we forget we were a bully in school), or other's actions towards ourselves (we forget the abuse we suffered at the hands of our parents). When we repress, we push painful memories out of awareness. Repression is different than suppression in that with repression, the memories don't typically pop up. They are deeply buried and functionally gone. Repression is the primary or root defense mechanisms. Many "higher level" defences are built upon the basic action of repression.
- [Regression](#) is the reversion to childlike emotional and psychological states that allow the individual to avoid painful awareness. Regression facilitates repression by allowing the individual to distract themselves and others with immature and inappropriate behaviour.
- [Dissociation](#) involves a complete detachment with reality (derealization) and with self (depersonalization). Like regression, this detachment facilitates repression of painful awareness.
- [Projection](#),¹⁸ occurs when one projects awareness of an uncomfortable memory or thing onto others. Instead of acknowledging your abuse of your own children, you see abuse in the children of other parents that surround you.

¹⁷<https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Repression>

¹⁸<https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Projection>

- Rationalization,¹⁹ whereby an individual finds justification and excuse for their own behaviour, or the behaviour of others. The CEO of a major corporation rationalizes exploiting child labour by suggesting the exploitation benefits the children because their families need money.
- Intellectualization,²⁰ which is when an individual engrosses themselves in the cognitive aspects of a thing, thereby avoiding the emotional aspects. An abusive spouse engages in cognitive analysis of the behavioural patterns in the home as a way of avoiding guilt and shame over their actions.

Awareness reduction mechanisms are important and deserve serious consideration, particularly because chronic reliance on awareness reduction mechanisms can compound difficulties. Chronic repression and avoidance of painful memories and disjunctive realities through the deployment of ARMs can compound psychological, emotional, spiritual, and even physical illness. In addition, suppressed and repressed memories impact actions and behaviours. Repressed emotions like fear and hatred fester and may grow toxic and infected over time. Unresolved traumas can manifest in physical illness.

So what do you do if you find that as you awaken, pain, anger, hatred, disjuncture, bad memories, awareness of your own toxic actions, etc. lead you to try to attempt to reduce awareness and go back to sleep? That depends on what exactly you are dealing with.

If you are dealing with trauma and damage from toxic socialization, if your bodily ego suffers from low self-esteem, lack of boundaries, then healing is what you need. For some basic guidance on how to approach

¹⁹<https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Rationalization>

²⁰<https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Intellectualization>

your healing process, go back and start with *LP Workbook Two: Healing*. Work through that and if you think you need additional help and guidance, get it.

Before closing this unit I would just like to say that in addition to using ARMs to reduce awareness of painful realities, your bodily ego can also behaviours, like shopping, or substances, like sugar, alcohol and certain drugs, to reduce awareness, numb emotions, or give one the good feelings one cannot, because of toxic environments and emotional damage, achieve naturally. Understand, engaging in behaviours or using substances to reduce awareness of internal and external realities is antithetical to the process of awakening, and antithetical to healing and reconnection. If you are doing this, you will have to stop at some point at some point, face and change reality, and find authentic healthy sources of joy. This will be a challenge, particularly since these behaviours and substances are addictive, but there are good resources and help is available. Just don't go back to sleep once you've started to wake up. Don't give up.

And with that, we come to an end of this unit on awakening. In this unit, we have looked at the nature of awakening. We have seen that awakening is filling the vessel with the consciousness of your higher self. Waking up is becoming more aware of your internal and external realities. Awakening is easy to initiate. An awakening affirmation gets the process started. The challenge comes when growing awareness leads you to confront painful realities inside and out. When you begin to confront painful realities, your bodily ego *naturally* works to reduce pain by reducing awareness so you can function in normal life. If you want to move forward, you will need to address, in an appropriate fashion, whatever issues need to be addressed so that you don't run off

back to sleep Otherwise you'll be firmly stuck in normal consciousness and unable to take a step forward.

Connection Coach Questions

1. The room you wake up in can impact whether your awakening experiences will be positive, negative, or some combination of the two. Think about the condition of your “room” (i.e. your family, workplaces, friend spaces, etc.) Does anything about the condition of the room *stand out* as something you might need to address as you begin to move forward towards connection?
Write your thoughts down and share with the group if you like.
2. Emotional and psychological damage can influence whether you have positive or negative experiences on the road to stronger connection. Think about your childhood, adolescence, and young adult hood. What comes to your mind when you ask yourself the question, “Is there any damage I have to deal with before I can wake up and face the room?” Write your thoughts down.
3. Review the ARMs introduced in this unit, as well as the information on behaviours and substances that can help you reduce pain. Do you think you use any ARMs to reduce your awareness of unpleasant realities and emotions? Do you use substances or engage in behaviours that help you reduce awareness and painful disjuncture? If so, write these down and briefly discuss them. Can you see the operation of these ARMs in others

around you? Give a couple of examples and discuss.

Accountability

Awakening, becoming more aware of the truths and realities that surround you and make up your life, is the first focus point in the LP Connection Framework. The second focus point is accountability. If you want to move forward, heal, and connect, then you have to be accountable.

What does it mean to be accountable? That is easy. Being accountable means taking responsibility for all your actions, good and bad, but especially bad. Being accountable means seeing and admitting that you have done something wrong, usually something that has harmed yourself or others. Being accountable means saying to yourself and others whom your actions have effected, “Yes, I did that and I take full responsibility.” When we are accountable, we do not make excuses, we do not pretend, and we do not dissemble. When we are accountable, we make an honest assessment of our actions and the impacts that these actions have had on others. When we are accountable, we own what we have done.

Accountability is something that becomes very important as you walk a path towards health and stronger connection. The requirement for accountability comes immediately upon the heels of awakening. When you wake up and see the mess in the room, you also wake up to the awareness that you are responsible for some, though perhaps not all, of that mess. For example, if you are an abusive spouse, when you wake up you will become aware of that abuse and its consequences, for your victims and your self. If you are a CEO that exploits employees and manipulates consumers, when you wake up you will become aware of that exploitation and manipulation and its negative consequences. If

you are a teacher that bullies some students, well, you get the picture. If there is some mess in the room, and if you have contributed to that mess, when you wake up you will become aware of that fact. Once you become aware, you will have to be accountable for your contribution to the mess. You'll have to say, yes I did that and I'm sorry.

The reason for this is not so much moral as it is simply the nature of your spiritual ego. Your Consciousness, your spiritual ego, your highest self, is not evil or bad in any way. Your higher self, your soul, is an entity of intelligence, wisdom, power, responsibility, strength, compassion, and love. When you connect, you connect with your spiritual ego and you bring it down into your body and forward into awareness. When you do that, you look at the mess and you say, I did that. It's that simple. You assess and take responsibility because that is what your spiritual ego, which is a being of love, light, awareness, compassion, power, and strength, would do, without question and without hesitation

Or at least, that is what should happen. Unfortunately, acknowledgement is not always exactly what happens. Sometimes there's resistance. Sometimes there's painful guilt and shame. Sometimes we're overwhelmed. If you do get to the point where you have seen and now must acknowledge, if at that point you are overwhelmed by guilt and shame, remember the advice from the last lesson.

Reference defenses arms, etc.

Forgive yourself. And then acknowledge

Inappropriate response to steering emotions is bad. Repressing guilt and shame or pretending the world is different than it really is, does not make the emotions go away, it just pushes them down below conscious awareness where they fester and build up over time. By the time we are thirty, forty, fifty, or older, our contribution to the mess might be quite significant, and the suppressed guilt and shame quite substantial. The more accumulated guilt and shame there is, the harder it becomes to acknowledge, atone, and release. As a parent, as a CEO, as a sexual predator, as an advertiser manipulating the masses in the pursuit of corporate profits, when awareness floods the vessel and we realize exactly what it is we have done over so many years, the guilt and shame can be so overwhelming and so seemingly beyond our ability to process that instead of taking responsibility, instead of being accountable, we instantly and instinctively use ARMs to reduce awareness and repress the emotions. We can be so forceful in our avoidance and repression that we even become violent when awareness is triggered.

So what do you do if this is your experience?

As silly as this might sound to some, if you find yourself filled with guilt and shame over actions in your past, simply forgive yourself. No matter what you have done, no matter how horrible it is, simply forgive yourself. Sure, you may have done some horrible things in your life. Sure, you may have hurt a lot of people, perhaps

even children. Sure, when you finally start to wake up you are going to realize you may **have** done a lot of bad things. But regardless of what you did, if you want to move forward, you simply have to forgive yourself.

What else is there to do?

If you do not forgive yourself, you invoke ARMs or consume substances to repress awareness and suppress guilt. If you do that, you will not be able to move forward. If you do not forgive yourself, the guilt and shame caused by your awareness will eventually overwhelm, and you will shut the light off and go back to sleep. It is inevitable and frankly, beyond your control. The physical unit is programmed to avoid pain and seek pleasure. It will automatically do what it takes to reduce the pain it feels. Therefore, the only way forward is to face whatever it is you have done and walk through the guilt and shame. Only by doing that will you be able to be accountable.

Weaponizing Your Emotions

Of course, saying we should forgive ourselves because this is the only way forward and actually doing it are two different things. The reality is, forgiving ourselves can be hard to do, not only because we may have accumulated a lot of guilt and shame but also because guilt and shame are weaponized against us by our familial, cultural, and religious traditions. Guilt and shame are

steering emotions, that is true; but these emotions are also easy to manipulate and exploit by people, institutions, governments, and corporations that want to control your behaviour. And they do. Many cultures and many religious traditions weaponize guilt and shame to one extent or another, and most people have learned from their parents, priests, or the media to use guilt and shame to hurt others. Until we are taught differently, many of us participate in this weaponization of steering emotions. Parents, siblings, teachers, priests, coworkers, even friends regularly use guilt and shame to control behaviour. Parents are usually the worst. There are virtually no checks on parental behaviour towards their children, and some parents literally torture their children with guilt and shame in order to keep them in line and under control. Priests, of course, use threats of exclusion and eternal damnation to invoke and reinforce guilt and shame to control. Teachers often do the same, in the old days going so far as putting dunce caps on children in order to publicly beat them with shame. The weaponization of guilt and shame is everywhere.

Of course, as already noted, guilt and shame are not bad emotions. Guilt and shame are supposed to help you control your behaviour. Guilt and shame are steering emotions and when they are properly linked to your internal compass, they do their job well. But when guilt and shame are weaponized in the

interests of external control of your behaviour, particularly when that control is aimed at fitting you as a cog into the System, they do not function properly. Instead, they become pathological. When guilt and shame are used against you by external sources, they become not something you respond to in order to steer the vehicle, but something to avoid at all costs because of the intense pain that is involved. When guilt and shame are weaponized, you learn not to be accountable and change your behaviour, you learn to avoid taking responsibility and lie about what you have done so that the external influences (parents, teachers) do not hurt you by invoking guilt and shame.

You can understand this more clearly if we do a simple thought experiment. Imagine you are a six-year-old boy playing with a frog and you accidentally squish that frog. A healthy six-year-old will feel bad about killing that frog, and this bad feeling will reduce the likelihood that this behaviour does not repeat in the future. Now imagine that the child's abusive parent sees the dead frog and instead of assuaging the guilt and explaining gently about being careful with live animals, the parent guilts and shames the child mercilessly. What do you think the child will learn from that? When guilt and shame are weaponized like this, then the next time the child does something that invokes guilt and shame, its post-traumatic response will not be to change behaviour but to desperately hide what it did so it will not be

exposed to further emotional trauma.

This is the same for all of us who have experienced the weaponization of guilt and shame. When awareness of a disjunctive action is brought to our awareness, for example, if we trigger in you the memory of something bad you did that one time long ago, you are not going to say, “Yes, I did that,” even to yourself; instead, you will desperately try to cover it up so you can a) pretend that it never happened and b) avoid being accountable for your actions because c) you have been taught that being accountable brings on the pain. Of course, if you do that, if you pretend that you never did that, or if you make excuses for the shitty things that you did, you will not be acknowledging your disjunctive actions, you will be repressing awareness. If you repress awareness, you are not moving forward, you are going back to sleep.

Punishment

Obviously, the toxic weaponize of guilt is a problem because it makes it harder to heal and connect by making it harder to stay aware and acknowledge your past actions, but there is more. Punishment (hitting, smacking, screaming, incarcerating, etc.) is also something that is associated with social control and punishment also makes it harder to acknowledge your bad actions.

Remember the little boy with the frog. Chances are he was not just shamed for his actions. Chances are, he was punished (read abused) for them as well. This is true for everybody. As children, as adolescents, even as adults, we are often assaulted when we do something “wrong.” This assault can be psychological, emotional, physical, or even spiritual.

The use of punishment to control behaviour is ubiquitous. As we will see in *LP Workbook Four*, the use of punishment to control is built into Western secular and religious ideology. In this ideology, we are told that punishment is good for us, that punishment is something that is God-given and justified. After all, if you are bad, God is going to send you to hell or karma is going to get you good. We absorb this ideology as children and learn from this ideology that it is OK to judge, punish, and harm people when they do something we see as wrong. Our parents tell us, as they hit and yell, that we deserve it. Our priests speak of damnation or karma for our sins. Our legal system hurts and punishes. The ideology that supports this is so pervasive that we all have the experience of being punished for actions that some parent, friend, teacher, priest, CEO, or life partner thought was wrong.

Punishment is, of course, an ineffective way of controlling behaviour and it also does incredible spiritual damage to people. While it might work in the short term, in the long term all it does

is teach us to lie to others about our actions. If I did something bad, for example, and I think that you finding out about it will expose me to some form of punishment, like verbal assault, physical assault, or jail time, I am not going to admit it for fear of pain and assault. Instead, I am going to hide and deny. If being aware and accountable means I am going to be punished, I am going to do whatever I can to suppress awareness and avoid accountability. Of course, if I do that, I am not going to be able to move forward, spiritually speaking. If I am not accountable for the bad things I have done, I am going to stay stuck in the somnambulism of normal consciousness, constantly invoking ARMs in order to avoid the guilt, shame, and violence.

So what do you do? When you wake and realize you have done some bad stuff, how do you forgive yourself and move forward past the ingrained guilt, shame, and fear? That can be a challenge, especially when you live in a society, or go to a Church, or hang out with friends, or live in a family, where guilt, shame, and punishment are regular weapons of choice. However, here are a couple of things you can do to make it easier to forgive yourself and move forward.

Number one, remember that guilt and shame are steering emotions. They are not designed to hurt you; they are designed to help your spiritual ego communicate. They are there to help your bodily ego steer the physical unit. If you feel bad about

doing something, stop doing that and you will feel better. If you are worried about telling others, do not tell, but do atone (more on atonement in the next unit) and do change your actions. Figuring out what your spiritual ego wants and doing that is the fastest and only way to alleviate guilt and shame. Everything else is simply repression.

Number two, if somebody around you is weaponizing guilt and shame, remember that guilt and shame have been weaponized. To protect yourself from this weaponization, first ask people politely to stop weaponizing your emotions. If they do not immediately stop, then avoid these people altogether. Remember, these people, these organizations, are not performing a useful social or spiritual function for you. In fact, exactly the opposite is true. People who weaponize guilt and shame are damaging your body's emotional systems and making it harder for you to move forward and connect. If you keep exposing yourself to that abuse, you will not be able to get things under control and you will never be able to acknowledge and move forward.

Number three, to deal with guilt, shame, and fear, it might help you to use a cleansing visualization. A [Cleansing Visualization](https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Cleansing_Visualization)²¹ is a visualization that helps you remove emotional toxins, like accumulated guilt and shame, from your body's emotional systems. To

²¹https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Cleansing_Visualization

do a cleansing visualization, see your body standing up, covered with a thick coating of wet, gloppy, **black gunk**. This **gunk** is guilt and shame, fear and anger. Tell yourself that you are awake and aware and that you will do what you need to move forward towards **stronger connection**. Say to yourself that you no longer need to carry this guilt and shame. Now, with these thoughts in mind, visualize your hands scrapping the gloppy mess off. Start at your head and work down to your toes, slowly and carefully scrapping the black tar with your hands, and wiping it off your body. As you do this, you slowly begin to reveal a beautiful, **gold** glowing figure previously hidden by the inky **gunk**. When you have finished scraping the **gunk** off your body, stand tall, strong, proud, powerful, and with the bright light of your powerful spiritual ego shining through. Repeat as necessary.

And that's all there is on accountability. To summarize, if you want to move forward towards connection, one of the first things you have to do after you awaken to reality is to acknowledge whatever bad actions you have committed in the past. You have to acknowledge the mess in your room. This is a necessary step, but it can be a challenge because acknowledging and admitting can invoke deeply buried guilt, shame, and even fear coming from those who have violently shamed and punished you in the past for doing something wrong. If you do find you struggle with guilt, shame, and fear, figure yourself, avoid the people that continue to harm, do a cleansing visualization to help remove the guilt and shame. Most importantly, change your behaviour. Once you awaken to reality and acknowledge your past "sins," stop the actions that cause

you guilt and shame. If you do not, no amount of cleansing will help you clear the emotions. Acknowledging your sins and changing your behaviours is the only way to finally clear guilt, shame, and fear.

Of course, it needs to be said here that just admitting you have done something wrong and stopping the disjunctive behaviours is not enough. It is only the second step. You have to become aware, you have to acknowledge and change your behaviour, but you also have to make up for the rotten behaviour that has hurt others. In other words, you have to atone. We shall talk more about atonement in the next unit, but before we do, understand, atonement is not punishment. Just like guilt and shame are not meant to provide an avenue of torture and social control, atonement is not meant to harm or hurt you. Atonement is just “making it right” so your spiritual ego, your highest self, can come sit in the body. We will look at this aspect of the LP Connection framework in the next unit. Until then, do not forget, forgive yourself.

Study questions

1. What are steering emotions? What are they used for? Think about your own emotional responses now. Do you feel guilt and shame? Do you feel joy and bliss? Around what actions, activities, or thoughts (past and present) do you feel these

emotions?

2. As noted, people unintentionally and intentionally weaponize guilt and shame. They do this to control behaviour or simply because this is what social ideology has taught them. Think about your family, friends, coworkers, and employers. Do any of them use guilt and shame to manipulate your behaviour? Do any of them engage in emotional, psychological, spiritual, or physical violence when you have done something they define as wrong? If so, what are some things that you can do to stop that weaponization?
3. Ask yourself the same question as above. Do you use guilt and shame as a weapon to control? Do you hurt others and then justify your abuse by saying they deserve it for their bad actions. If so, what are some things that you do to stop this damaging behaviour?
4. What are some actions you can take to overcome guilt, shame, and the fear of punishment that make it harder to acknowledge actions. What would you say to others about the importance of acknowledging past actions? What would you tell others if they were experiencing debilitating guilt and shame that made it difficult for them to acknowledge their actions?

Atonement

So far in this workbook, we have looked at awakening and accountability as two important focus points in the LP Connection Framework. Once you have made progress on these first two points, once you wake up and see the true state of the room and once you own up and take responsibility for your part in any of the messes that surround you, the next step in the process is to atone.

What is atonement? Basically, atonement is reparation for the harm you have caused to other people and other living beings. More to the point, atonement is taking responsibility and cleaning up the mess that you made. It does not matter what that **mess** is or how extensive it might be; once you get past the guilt, shame, and fear, once you acknowledge your part in the mess, then you have to atone.

As regards atonement, a couple of comments are in order. **First off**, atonement is not a moral requirement, it is a technical one.

Atonement is not about following somebody's orders or rules.

You do not atone because some priest, imam, guru, or even God tells you to. Atonement is simply about making it right. It is about reparation for harms you have caused to other living beings. This is about your relationship with your spiritual ego, the capital "Y" You deep inside. You atone, you "make it right," because that is what your own Higher Self requires you to do.

You can think of it like this. Your higher self, your spiritual ego, is the spiritual adult in you. Like all adults, it takes responsibility for

the things that its vehicle, its body, does. A child might spill milk and walk away from the mess, but an adult does not. An adult cleans it up. An adult breaks something and fixes it (or has it fixed). An adult will even help clean up the mess of others if it can help because that is what responsible adults do. Your spiritual ego is the spiritual adult in you and when you wake up and see the mess in the room, it immediately moves to take responsibility and take action to clean up the mess. Its body can resist, of course, but that does not matter. As we shall see in the next unit on alignment, until the body aligns and does what the spiritual wants it to do, it cannot move forward towards connection.

Second of all, all actions that harm another living being require atonement, even if you find you had good reason to harm. For example, you might think that hurting somebody in self-defence is an act that does not require atonement. You might think that you are justified in taking brutal actions or harming another to project yourself, and of course, you are. You have every right to protect yourself and your family. However, the fact that a harmful act may be justifiable does not mean you can simply harm another being and walk away from the mess, even if justified.

When violence occurs, whether that violence is physical, emotional, psychological, or spiritual, everybody involved in the act is harmed, and this harm must be addressed. The perpetrator engages in harmful acts against others because they are often hurt, damaged, angry, addicted, and desperate as a consequence of their toxic their

socialization experiences. Even though they have harmed others, nevertheless, they need help and healing, not further harm. Similarly, the victims of the assault are also harmed, not only by the attack itself but by the violence they engage in to divert the attack. Even though the defence is justified, it still harms them when they engage in violence against others. If I have to harm another being because I am defending myself, I experience psychological and emotional harm, neurological changes, and other shifts that, unless addressed, can change me, cause disjuncture, and interfere with my attempts to connect.

The **idea** that all harmful acts require atonement may seem a little strange to many, especially in this modern world where we hide the brutal torture of animals from our awareness so we can eat meat, and ignore the exploitation of women and children in factories in other countries so that we can have lots of clothes and things. Nevertheless, it is true. When we engage in harmful acts, we must be aware of the damage, we must be accountable for its impact, and we must atone for the damage we have caused, even if we find ourselves justified in the actions.

Third, and despite what we just said that all actions that harm another living being require atonement, it is important to understand, not all actions that harm another being are unaligned or require atonement. Perhaps this goes without saying, but it is important to be aware, it is possible to hurt others and not be out of alignment with higher consciousness. A doctor who stitches a wound or a dentist who sticks a needle in your mouth to fill a rotten tooth is hurting you; however, the actions lead directly to healing and are therefore in alignment with **spiritual ego**. Actions like these require no significant atonement

because there is positive/healing intent behind them, and healing outcomes flow. Of course, a connected doctor or dentist will do what they can to minimize pain, and you might even find them apologizing for the hurt they cause. That is great and indicates alignment, but it is not **technically** necessary because the acts are not contributing to toxicity and decline.

Atonement requirements

Now that we understand the nature of atonement, that it is about cleaning up your mess, and now that we have an idea under what conditions it is necessary, the question becomes how to atone.

The first thing to be aware of is that when you atone, and this really should go without saying, you first need to **stop the actions that are causing harm**. Apologizing and making amends, but then turning around and continuing to harm other beings, is not awareness, accountability, and atonement; it is hypocrisy, self-delusion, and the sign of an underlying pathology of some sort. If you do find yourself engaging in self-delusion and hypocrisy, apologizing but then re-harming, take a step back to *LP* , and work through those focus points again.

The **second thing** you need to be aware of is that whatever you have done, you need to **atone in appropriate measure**. This means that the more damage you have done, the more you have to make up for. If you have abused your children for two decades, an apology and a few dollars are not going to cut it. Similarly, if you have stolen a hundred billion dollars from the people of this planet, if your company is responsible for climate change, charity is not nearly enough. *Making*

it right means fixing the damage you have done in measure. If you want to move forward, you have to stop hurting and exploiting others, and you have to make amends in measure. This requires more than just a few pennies, good intent, and a few choice words. It requires fundamental changes in how you exist in the world.

If you bristle at and resist what we are saying at this point, remember this; you need to do this not because we say you have to do it, not because “God” wants it that way, and not because karma is going to smack you down if you do not. You need to do it because the driver of the physical vehicle, your **spiritual ego**, expects it that way. If you are a billionaire and you feel good about giving away a hundred bucks, if ten hours of volunteer work is enough, or if being a little nicer as a manager is what it takes to satisfy your Self and make you feel good, then that is great. But if it is not enough in the eyes of your own **spiritual ego**, then it is not enough. If you get that niggling feeling that you should be doing more, then **do not** make excuses; do more. Either awaken, acknowledge, atone in measure and move forward, or not. It is as simple as that.

The third thing you need to be aware of is that **you need to be honest with yourself about the nature of the damage and the extent of the atonement required.** Do not try and kid your Self, your spiritual ego, on this, because you cannot. Your **spiritual ego** knows what you have done, it has expectations about what you need to atone for, and ideas about how much you need to do. To be aligned, you need to respond to the requirements of your **spiritual ego**, period.

If you are paying attention, responding to your **spiritual ego** is not that

hard to do. As already noted, your **spiritual ego** will use steering emotions to get the message through. It will send you feelings of discomfort and make you anxious if there are things you need to be doing, and it will send you joy and good feelings if you are atoning in the right direction and with right measure. Pay attention to your emotions and you will find it easier to move forward.

Speaking of paying attention to your spiritual ego, the fourth thing you should be aware of in this regard is that **nobody can tell you what atonement means for you**. I cannot tell you what the right measure is or what you should do to make things right, and neither can a judge, lawyer, priest, or a guru. Only you, ideally in connected consultation with your **spiritual ego**, can figure that out. You may ask for advice, that is true, but nobody can tell you what you need to do. This is something you need to figure out for yourself. **And once again**, trust your gut on this one. Figure out something to do that makes you feel good about yourself and that gives you joy, and do it as long and as much as you need until you feel that you have done enough.

If this sounds a little complicated, or if you are struggling with confidence and self-esteem here (i.e. you doubt your ability to figure it out), relax. It is not as hard as you might think. In fact, chances are good that when you are ready to atone, opportunities will already be available for you. Pay attention to your life spaces and seize the opportunities when they arise.

Atoning in right measure and finding something appropriate are both important. It is also important, and this is the fifth and most important thing we would like to say, to **have as much fun as you can while you atone**. To be sure, you have to fix what you broke and you have to

make amends for damage you have done, but you do not have to waste effort breaking rocks in a ditch while you do it, despite what you may have heard. Spiritually and psychologically misinformed people make out atonement to be all about punishment. They say “justice” demands isolation, deprivation, hard labour, and even hellfire, but that is ridiculous. Hurting another being because they have hurt another being just makes things worse. As Gandhi said, “An eye for an eye makes the whole world blind;” punishing people just causes more damage. You definitely have to atone for the harm you have done, but you do not have to be miserable while you do it. The easiest and fastest way to atone is to find something you love doing, and do that until you **you** **have** balanced the scales, so to speak.

Always remember, this is all about healing and connection and not punishment and isolation. Healing your body, aligning with your **spiritual ego**, activating your body’s energy system, and reconnecting with your **highest self** requires healthy bodies and healthy minds. If the goal is to stop the hurt and heal the body so you can acknowledge, atone, and connect, then how can engaging in an unaligned act towards another (i.e. harming them) or exposing yourself to anguish and abuse be helpful in any way? The answer is, it cannot be. Just like all disjunctive and violent actions, punishment (which is always a violent act) harms you and it harms the victims. Punishment, whether punishing yourself with painful atonement, or punishing others with violence and pain, is the pinnacle of spiritual confusion and the height of global hypocrisy. Not only does it spread damage further by harming others, but it puts you out of alignment with your own higher consciousness. Stopping the hurt and healing the body means stopping

the hurt and healing the body for all people, not just the ones judged to be worthy.

Remember, punishment just continues the harm and makes things worse. Therefore, listen carefully when we say that atonement works best when it involves happy action and joyful contribution. It is just common sense. You will do a much better job making things right, you will make much better progress towards healing and connection, and you will be much less likely to hurt yourself and others when you are happy and having fun with the atonement that you do. This is critical advice. Make your atonement work and the atonement work of others fun. Embrace the good feelings that come. Not only is the best way forward to healing and stronger connection, it is how it was meant to be. God, Consciousness, your spiritual ego does not want you to suffer on a downward spiral to hell. It wants you to dance back to the Garden.

Finally, the last thing we want to say here is that **you do not necessarily have to atone directly to the people you have harmed.** It would be best if you could, that is true. If you have harmed your children, your parents, your workers, children in a factory, or whatever, it is best if you make amends to them directly. However, doing that is not always possible. Sometimes, the people you have harmed hate you and do not want to have anything to do with you. Sometimes, they are far away and direct atonement is not possible. Sometimes, they are sick and lost in their own hellish experience of disconnection and will not benefit from your assistance. Sometimes, they are dead. Whatever the reason is, understand, sometimes direct atonement with the people you have harmed is just not possible.

If this is you, try direct atonement first; however, if you cannot for whatever reason atone directly, make up for it by finding a way to help

others, and then do that in the measure required. Just be honest with yourself about how much you need to do, be in tune with your **spiritual ego**, and find a joyful way to do it.

Commitment and Foundations

At this point, we have said all there is to say about the requirement of atonement. As you can see, it is fairly simple and straightforward, at least theoretically. Be aware of the mess in the room, be accountable for the damage you have caused, and atone. If you do that you are building the foundations of connection.

Now, as simple as this all is, as we have seen, is not always so easy to do. As much as we say you should forgive yourself, as much as we say you should forgive others, and as much as we emphasize it should be joyful, nevertheless, it can be hard work. There are emotional obstacles to overcome (guilt, shame, fear); there are motivational obstacles to overcome; there are even healing issues that have to be addressed. And that is not all.

Waking up to the reality of the world, acknowledging the things you have done, and taking steps to atone and align can be hard because it can mean giving up things you otherwise like to do. I like a good hamburger, but I will no longer eat one because it is unnecessary, because doing so harms another living being and is therefore out of alignment with my **spiritual ego**, and because it is hard on the environment. Some people find gambling exciting, but addicts harm themselves and their families, and so that behaviour has to stop as well. It can be particularly hard to move forward if you are rich and

addicted to money.²² As a rich person, are you just going to do the right thing by giving “your”²³ wealth away through taxation and redistribution? Are you really going to allow capitalism to die and be replaced by a less toxic and dysfunctional economic system? It is clear from the actions of the global oligarchy on the world stage that the answer here is no. The rich would rather harm their own people and go to war with other nations than let the planet properly evolve. It is a camel through the eye of the needle sort of thing, meaning to say, the more powerful and privileged you are, the harder and harder it is to give up that privilege, the harder it is to acknowledge the exploitation that got you there, and the harder it is to atone by giving it *all* back. Nevertheless, no matter what, you have to do it; otherwise you will not be able to move forward and you will not be able to connect.

If you do find you are having trouble with awakening, accountability, and atonement, perhaps because you have addictions (like [addiction to money](#))²⁴ or other issues (low-self-esteem issues, for example) that prevent you from engaging with and sticking to the process, take a step back to *Lightning Path Workbook Two* and the healing stage. There is no point trying to push through when the healing foundations are not in

²²Money is definitely an addiction. See Mike Sosteric, “How Money Is Destroying the World,” *The Conversation*, 2018, <https://theconversation.com/how-money-is-destroying-the-world-96517>.

²³As pointed out in *Rocket Scientists’ Guide to Money and the Economy*, the wealth that the rich accumulate isn’t really theirs. They do not really “make” that money. They steal labour from the workers and accumulate that labour in the form of money. In light of this, some form of redistribution as atonement is required. Anything else just perpetuates the problem

²⁴Sosteric, “How Money Is Destroying the World.”

place. If you do not build a proper foundation, then you will not be able to atone properly and you will only be able to manage a connection or two here and there, if that—and that is not nearly enough.

Remember, the point of this is **not** to have one or two mystical experiences here and there. The point is to develop a strong and permanent connection. To do that, you need to build a foundation. Take your time and do it right. Remember, this is **not** a race and no connected person is going to think poorly of you if you got some healing work to do. Be methodical about this and **do not** skip steps. You are just wasting time if you do.

Natural Consequences

Before closing out this unit and moving on to our next unit on alignment, there is one more thing to say and that is this: just because the requirement of atonement is not moral or ethical, just because you will not be punished or damned for failing to move forward from here, does not mean there are no consequences for your choice. There are consequences, for you and others.

One of the biggest *personal* consequences is that if you do not take the necessary steps to process and move forward, you will never be able to connect more than a moment or two, and you will thus never be able to raise your [Consciousness Quotient](https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Consciousness_Quotient)²⁵ much above the level of [Normal Consciousness](https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Normal_Consciousness),²⁶ which is the

²⁵https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Consciousness_Quotient

²⁶https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Normal_Consciousness

everyday waking consciousness of your average disconnected modern citizen. That might not seem like a big deal now; after all, everybody walks around in normal consciousness, but it is a big deal because as more and more people heal and connect, “normal” is going to look increasingly like the broke and disconnected pathology that it is. That is going to make it harder and harder for people stuck in normal consciousness to repress their guilt and shame, and harder and harder for them to live a comfortable, self-delusional life. For some, the disjuncture could become so intolerable that they descend into despair, addiction, anger, hatred, and fear. For others, the existential anguish might be so great that awareness reduction with drugs and alcohol might not be enough, and suicide may feel like their only solution, as it was for Dr. Van Koinis, who forged vaccination records and then later took his life because he could not stand the guilt and shame.²⁷

A second consequence of failure to atone and move forward is this. Normal consciousness is a consciousness characterized by the slow decay of your body and mind. Remember the seven essential needs. Just like your physical body needs food, your physical unit *needs* to connect, not for some hokey spiritual reason, but because connection keeps the body and mind healthy and alive. If you do not connect, your mind will slowly

²⁷Meaghan Wray, “Doctor Who Allegedly Forged Vaccine Records Cites ‘Regrets’ in Suicide Note,” Global News, 2020, <https://globalnews.ca/news/6552342/doctor-suicide-note-vaccines/>.

harden and become brittle, and your body will suffer as well. It is a fate that is totally unnecessary and preventable, so long as you move forward and develop a persistent connection.

Understand, this is not about punishment. This is not a judgment issued for failure. Growing disjunctive pain and decline of the body and mind are simply the natural consequences of a failure to connect. It is the same if you avoid exercise and eat nothing but junk food. If you do that, then *naturally* your body and mind will deteriorate and you will get sick. This is not a judgment. It is simply a natural consequence of your bad exercise and eating habits.

The bottom line is, if you choose to live disconnected from your spiritual ego you will, at best, live as a shadow of your true Self and potential. At worst, you will twist, distort, embitter, get sick, and become increasingly uncomfortable in the ascending consciousness of this planet. It is not a question of judgment or punishment. It is just a natural consequence of your choices and actions. If you want to avoid all that, awaken, acknowledge, and atone.

Study questions

1. What is atonement? What is atonement in right measure? Why is atonement necessary?
2. What actions have you taken in your life that have harmed another being? Include direct harm, like assaulting your children, shaming others, eating meat, and also indirect harm, like purchasing clothes made in sweatshops, unnecessary

purchases that harm the environment, etc. Be thorough. Write these down and do not be shy or ashamed. We have all engaged in harmful acts. The point here is not about shaming, judgment, and punishment; the point is awareness, accountability, and atonement.

3. What are some of the natural consequences that might accrue to you if you do not acknowledge and atone? What are natural consequences that might accrue if you fail to establish a pure and persistent connection?

Alignment

So far in this workbook, we have looked at awakening, accountability, and atonement. These three connection focus points form the bottom or foundational triangle in the LP Connection Framework. In this unit, we are going to continue our connection training by starting with the top triangle—alignment, activation, and ascension. We will start our exploration with the all-important concept of **alignment**.

We have already looked at alignment briefly in the previous unit, so chances are you have a basic understanding; however, alignment is a critical spiritual concept and so it is important to understand it in depth. To fully understand what alignment is and why it is so important, let us take a step backwards and briefly talk about what it means to live a spiritual life and be a spiritual person. Let us ask two questions the answers to which fully define the nature of spirituality.

- What does it mean to be spiritual?
- What does it mean to lead an authentic spiritual life?

You already know, from *LP Workbook One*, that being spiritual means connecting and filling the water glass (your body) with the water of your own higher Consciousness. You already know, from previous units in this workbook, that an authentic spiritual life is a life conducted in pursuit of a better connection to your spiritual ego. This is great as a general conceptualization and root for visualization, but it leaves many of the specifics out. To deepen our understanding of authentic spirituality and connection, and to answer the above questions more specifically, let us revisit the [automobile metaphor](#).²⁸ To use the

²⁸The automobile metaphor is a metaphor used to illustrate the relationship between

automobile metaphor, think of your body as a car, a powerful red Ferrari, and think of your **spiritual ego** like the experienced driver of that car. Using this visual, you can understand what it means to be spiritual, what it means to live a spiritual life, and what the full nature of spirituality is as nothing more or less than the processes involved in getting into the car (i.e. the physical vehicle) and driving it around creation in an effective, sensible, safe, and spiritually aligned way.

That is all there is to it.

If you want to live a spiritual life, if you want to be a spiritual person, if you want to complete the spiritual awakening and connection process, then get your **spiritual ego** fully into the car (your physical body) and drive it around in an aligned fashion.

Of course, the million-dollar question now is just what is an aligned use of the physical vehicle? If you think of the automobile as your physical unit and the driver of that car as your spiritual ego, then *alignment occurs when you get into the car and the car drives exactly the way you want it to drive*. If you press the gas, the car accelerates; if you hit the brakes, the car slows down; if you turn right, the car turns right; if you bank left, well, you get the idea. Your car is in alignment when it does what you, the driver, wants it to do, but it is out of alignment when it does not. If you are driving in your car on the highway and you hit the brakes to avoid an obstacle but the car accelerates, then the car is dangerously out of alignment with the will/intent of the driver. Similarly, if you turn the wheel left but the car turns right, it is out of alignment.

It is the same with your physical unit. Your physical unit is in

spiritual ego as driver, and physical unit as vehicle.

https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Automobile_Metaphor.

alignment when it does what your **spiritual ego** wants it to do. It is out of alignment when it does not. If your **spiritual** wants its body to do a certain thing and it does it, it is aligned. If the body refuses to act in accordance with the intent of the **spiritual ego**, it is not aligned. Simple.

Note, the above alignment advice applies not only to behaviour but also to thought and to environments. When you think in accordance with what your **spiritual ego** thinks, you are in alignment. If you think in a way that is not like your spiritual ego, you are out of alignment. When you organize your environments in accordance with what your spiritual ego wants, you are in alignment. If you do not, you are not.

We can now return to our two questions concerning the nature of spirituality. Recall these questions:

- What does it mean to be spiritual?
- What does it mean to lead a spiritual life?

With the automobile metaphor and concept of alignment in mind, we can say that *being spiritual means being aligned*. We can also say that *you are living a spiritual life when your physical unit is aligned with the thoughts, wishes and intent of your spiritual ego*.

How to be aligned?

Alignment is important. For reasons that we will explore in more detail below, if you are out of alignment, you will find connecting with your spiritual ego difficult, if not impossible. The question now becomes, how do you know what your spiritual ego wants? How do you know what your spiritual ego thinks? If you are not aligned, how do you

know that and, finally, how do you move in the direction of spiritual alignment?

On the one hand, determining what the spiritual ego thinks and what it wants to do with its vehicle can be easy. When you are in a state of awakened connection, when your bodily ego is connected to your spiritual ego, you know exactly what the spiritual ego thinks and exactly what it wants because when you are connected, the spiritual ego is present and its thoughts and desires flow freely in your Stream of Consciousness.²⁹ When you are connected, it is like your spiritual ego is sitting in the room with you, freely talking. The problem is, we all experience a toxic socialization process designed to damage and disconnect us. When we are disconnected, we do not communicate easily and openly with the spiritual ego. It is a bit of a catch 22. You need to be connected to determine alignment easily, but you need to be aligned to get a better connection.

So what do you do? If you want to move towards alignment while disconnected, there are two things you **can** do. You **can**

- a) Follow somebody else's alignment rules and you can
- b) Listen to *emotional semaphore* to determine how to think and behave.

Following Alignment Rule Sets

As for following somebody else's alignment rules, there is a long history in religious and spiritual traditions of this planet of

²⁹http://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Stream_of_Consciousness

providing what we might call [Alignment Rule Sets](#).³⁰ An alignment rule set is a collection of rules and guidelines designed to help a physical unit achieve and maintain alignment with its spiritual ego, despite being in a state of disconnection. Consider the Christian Ten Commandments, the Buddhist Eightfold Path,³¹ and even the LP's own admonishments to establish **right action**, **right thought**, and **right environment**. These are all alignment rule sets. Alignment rule sets, which you were introduced to in the LP 135 course "[An Introduction to Wrong Thought](#)," stipulate how to think and behave (i.e., don't kill, don't steal, don't harm others, don't think ill of your neighbour, etc.) in a spiritually aligned way. Alignment rule sets are designed to facilitate alignment and move you towards connection even when you are completely disconnected, toxic, and confused.

Following alignment rule sets is a good way to get started on alignment, but there is one caveat to keep in mind. The general rules provided by alignment rule sets only provide general guidance. The rules do not contain specifics that might be appropriate for you. A rule that says "thou shall not kill" or "do not steal what is not yours" or "engage in right livelihood" is an important alignment rule that applies to everybody without exception. However, lots of other actions and ideas are relevant to alignment but do not always apply across the board. For example, I have an alignment rule that says "wake up and write every morning for a few hours." I need this "rule" because that's what my **spiritual ego** wants me to do. When I get up and write every day, I am aligned with my **spiritual ego**. Others, like musicians,

³⁰https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Alignment_Rule_Set

³¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Noble_Eightfold_Path

healers, empaths, parents, etc., need different alignment guidance. An alignment rule for parents might be, do not verbally, emotionally, or physically assault your kids. An alignment rule for a musician might be, practice three hours a day. An alignment rule for empaths might be “avoid toxic environments.” You get the picture. These sorts of specific rules cannot be formulated into general alignment rule sets because they do not make sense for everybody. That is ok because you can formulate specific alignment rule sets. We could develop alignment rule sets for empaths,³² for teachers, healers, doctors, and so on. In fact, we often do. The ethical guidelines that some disciplines formulate (think Hippocratic Oath for doctors) are, in essence, disciplinary alignment rules.

Listening to emotional semaphore

Alignment rule sets are not the only way to achieve alignment when you find yourself disconnected. A complementary way to aim towards alignment is to pay attention to emotional semaphore.

As you already know, [Emotional Semaphore](#)³³ refers to the alignment guidance your spiritual ego provides by manipulating the emotional mechanisms of the physical unit. When you do something out of alignment, the spiritual ego will “strum” negative [Steering Emotions](#)³⁴ like guilt and shame to indicate misalignment. When you are doing something aligned, the spiritual ego will strum positive steering emotions like pride, joy, bliss, indicate aligned actions, thoughts, and environment.

³²As for example the “What is an empath” series of articles provided on the LP site. <https://www.lightningpath.org/mikesblog/what-is-an-empath/>

³³https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Emotional_Semaphore

³⁴https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Steering_Emotion

Listening to emotional semaphore is easy. If an action or inaction makes you feel bad, if it makes you feel anxious, guilty, and shameful, then *do not* do it because it is certainly out of alignment. On the other hand, if an action or inaction makes you feel good, if you feel that something is the “right thing to do,” then do it. To gather the specifics of your alignment, do what makes you feel good about yourself and do not do things that make you feel bad. If you do that, you will be travelling a fast path towards greater alignment, even if you are profoundly disconnected from Consciousness.

To recap what we have said so far, **you** are aligned when your physical unit thinks and behaves as your spiritual ego (i.e., the driver of the vehicle) wishes it to. **You** are out of alignment when it does not. If you have a strong connection to Consciousness already, determining how to think and act in an aligned fashion is easy. If you are early on in the spiritual training process, if you are as yet disconnected, then following general and more specific alignment rule sets, and learning to pay attention to emotional semaphore, can get you pointed in the right direction.

The Push/Pull of Misalignment

At this point, you should have a good idea what alignment is and how to achieve it. The only question left to answer here is, why is alignment important? The answer is simple. You cannot go very far on any spiritual path if your body is not making progress towards better alignment with **spiritual ego**. It is not for moral reasons, it is for technical ones. You **cannot** connect unless aligned not because God will punish you for being bad, not because some karmic principle will

“get you” if you **do not** act correctly, but because it is technically impossible to do so.

Why?

It has to do with a “push-pull” that occurs between the bodily ego and spiritual ego when things are out of alignment. When you are out of alignment, your spiritual ego **pulls away** from the bodily ego unit because it does not want to be close to the disjunctive actions of the body, which are painful to it, and it does not want to make things worse. For its own part, when it is out of alignment, the bodily ego pushes its own spiritual ego away to try and avoid the painful guilt, shame, and disjuncture that inevitably occurs when it thinks and acts out of alignment. Let us look at each of these in more detail, starting with the spiritual ego.

Spiritual Ego

As regards the spiritual ego, there are at least three reasons why your spiritual ego might pull away from the bodily ego. The spiritual ego might pull away because

- a) It wants to avoid unnecessary pain and anguish to itself.
- b) It wants to avoid unnecessary pain and anguish to its body.
- c) It wants to “power down” its own body to reduce its negative impact on the world.

The first reason your spiritual ego might pull away from an unaligned physical vehicle is because it **does not** want to cause itself unnecessary pain and anguish. The truth is, being present in a body

when the body is far out of alignment is painful to your **spiritual ego**. Your **spiritual ego** is a being of love, light, compassion, and empathy. As such, your **spiritual ego** does not like negativity at all, and it certainly does not like violence. It does not like it when its body surrounds itself with **negativity and toxicity**, and it does not like it **when its body** participates in violence and exploitation. It does not like when its body harms others. When its physical unit exists in toxic environments and when it is doing **unaligned things**, the spiritual ego pulls away because the negativity and violence are painful to be around.

To be perfectly clear about this, and despite propaganda and self-delusion to the contrary (i.e., notions that pain and struggle and violence and toxicity “build character”, or whatever), the old energy world “as it exists” with all its exploitation, self-delusion, hatred, anger, pain, suffering, and horror is literal hell to your **spiritual ego**. Your **spiritual ego** avoids the toxicity and nonsense of the old energy world like you avoid putting your hand into an open flame. It withdraws because it cannot stand the toxic fires that surround it.

Now, a **second reason** that the **spiritual ego** might pull away from an unaligned physical unit is to avoid causing the physical unit and the bodily ego additional pain and suffering. As we have seen, when the physical unit is out of alignment, the spiritual ego uses steering emotions to try and align the behaviour of its disconnected physical unit. Sometimes, for various reasons, the physical unit does not listen to emotional semaphore. Sometimes, because of ignorance, psychological or emotional pathology, self-defence, external resistance, or cussed

stubbornness, the emotional messages either do not get through or the bodily ego simply ignores them. When that happens, when the bodily ego does not respond to emotional semaphore, painful negative emotions of guilt and shame can build up over time. Eventually, these can become intolerable. In these situations, the spiritual ego might pull away from its own physical unit in an effort to reduce the existential pain its body is suffering. Withdrawing from the physical unit helps reduce the pain because withdrawing reduces painful disjuncture by lowering awareness. The less aware and awake one is, the less sensitive one is to pain. It is like being poked with a pin while you are in a coma versus being poked with a pin when you are awake and alert. When you are in a coma, you do not feel the pain. When you are awake, you do. The more conscious you are, the more connected you are, the more aware you are of your own suffering. For this reason, when your body is suffering a lot, the spiritual ego will pull away. This is a very important point, so let us repeat. In disjunctive, toxic, and oppressive realities where the body will not or cannot make changes, Consciousness will withdraw to reduce awareness and avoid causing ineffectual and, as a consequence, unnecessary and damaging emotional pain.

A third reason the spiritual can pull away from its physical unit is when its physical unit is causing suffering to others. If the body is hurting others, if you are hurting others, your spiritual ego will pull away. This might seem a little odd, but when you think about it, it makes perfect sense. Recall the automobile metaphor here. Your spiritual ego is the owner of the physical unit like you might be the owner of a motor vehicle. When you get into a motor vehicle, you

expect it to drive the way you want it to drive. If the car does not do what you want it to do, that is, if it is not aligned with your intent, if it accelerates when you brake or unexpectedly veers into pedestrians, you would continue to drive it around; you would get out of the vehicle. You would then work to have it fixed. If you cannot fix it, you would take it off the road and find another vehicle.

It is the same with **your spiritual ego**. As **your spiritual ego** enters the vehicle, it puts pressure on the vehicle to act in alignment. If the physical vehicle is healthy, aligned, and functioning properly, everything is OK. However, if it is acting badly, the spiritual ego will withdraw in an attempt to power down the physical unit, just like you get out of a car that is not working to avoid harming others. For reasons we will not get into here, it will not withdraw completely, but it can power down and withdraw to avoid giving its misbehaving physical unit unnecessary power and support.

Bodily Ego

As noted, when the body is not in alignment with its spiritual ego, the spiritual ego will pull away from the body, thereby lowering the awareness, sensitivity, and power of the physical unit. The other side of this push-pull coin comes into effect when the bodily ego pushes its own spiritual ego away. The bodily ego will push the spiritual ego for one reason and one reason only, when it experiences [Disjunctive Emotions](https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Disjunctive_Emotions)³⁵ of anxiety, guilt, shame, stress, fear, confusion, and even paranoia as a consequence of connection. It can experience these things, these disjunctive emotions, for several reasons, including

³⁵https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Disjunctive_Emotions

1. Lack of preparation.
2. An ego damaged by toxic socialization.
3. Lack of Alignment

One of the first things that can cause disjunctive emotions, thereby causing the bodily ego to push the spiritual ego away, is **lack of preparation**. Lack of preparation is a problem because the Consciousness of the spiritual ego is powerful and it can be hard to handle even under the best of circumstances. Consciousness, *real* Consciousness, the Consciousness that makes up your spiritual ego, is nothing like the watered-down version provided by the brain and CNS, the kind you get while operating in normal consciousness. It is nothing like the dim candlelight of your bodily ego. Consciousness is bright like the sun and powerful like an atom bomb. If you, and by you I mean your bodily ego, brain, and CNS, want to be able to handle even a little bit of that Consciousness, if you do not want the bodily ego to be exhausted by the experience, blinded back into normal consciousness, cast dramatically into a [Nadir Experience](#)³⁶ of anxiety, confusion, and fear, or even hurtled into a full-blown

³⁶For your information, a nadir experience is a negatively felt connection experience. Nadir experiences are unpleasant moments of stress, anxiety, anger, confusion, fear, and even paranoia that can sometimes occur when you make a connection.
https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Nadir_Experience

[Connection Pathology](#)³⁷ like egoic bloating³⁸ or full ego explosion,³⁹ you have to prepare. Without proper preparation, you increase the chance of having a difficult experience. If you have a difficult experience, the bodily ego may push its powerful spiritual ego away, temporarily or more permanently if the experience is really bad, in order to return to a calm semblance of normal.

Of course, the question now is, how do you prepare for connection? The answer is simple. In general, study an authentic spirituality and put into [Connection Practice](#)⁴⁰ the guidance and advice. The term connection practice refers to the regular and disciplined daily practice of [Connection](#) using various techniques and strategies for improvement. Connection practice typically consists of using various [Connection Techniques](#), like mindfulness, meditation, Zazen, intent, affirmation, etc., to open a wider connection, and then using [Flow Purification](#) and [Flow Control](#) to ensure positive and empowering [Flow](#).

If this whole idea of preparation has you a little concerned, do not be. If you have been progressing through the LP Workbooks you have already done quite a bit to prepare yourself. We have not covered

³⁷A connection pathology is a psychological/emotional breakdown of the bodily ego caused by a negative connection experience.
https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Connection_Pathology

³⁸ Egoic Bloating is a pathological and artificial bloating of the Bodily Ego caused by a Connection Experience for which one is improperly prepared. Egoic bloating is represented by unwarranted beliefs in one's intellectual, emotional, evolutionary, or spiritual superiority. Egoic bloating often occurs in individuals with severely damaged self-esteem. https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Egoic_Bloating

³⁹An Egoic Explosion is a temporary or permanent collapse of the Bodily Ego caused when an unprepared Bodily Ego makes a strong Connection to Consciousness.
https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Egoic_Explosion

⁴⁰ https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Connection_Practice

everything just yet. There is still work to do, but if you have gotten this far, you are already better prepared than you were when you started.

In addition to lack of preparation, a second thing that can cause your bodily ego to push your spiritual ego away is when it is **weakened or damaged by toxic socialization**. Weakened and damaged egos struggle with the powerful light of the spiritual ego. Why? In a nutshell, emotional, psychological, and intellectual **adaptations and distortions** caused by the damage of toxic socialization combine with lack of preparation and lack of trust to cause anxiety, fear, anger, hatred, and even paranoia. The toxic psychological and emotional soup caused by ego damage makes it harder to cope with the blinding light of the spiritual ego. There are lots of different reasons for this. For example, the presence of ideology seeded during the toxic socialization process can cause confusion and even paranoia. In addition, damage to the bodily ego's ability to trust caused by abusive parents, teachers, or friends, can contribute to anxiety and fear during the connection process. In rare cases where the individual experienced chronic, daily psychological or emotional traumatization, connection can cause complete [egoic collapse](#). For all the reasons noted above and more, if your bodily ego is damaged and weakened by toxic socialization, you have to work to heal and strengthen it, otherwise you will find yourself suppressing your own spiritual ego and pushing away opportunities for better connection.

A final reason your bodily ego will push your spiritual ego away is lack of alignment in thought, action, and environment. Remember, alignment refers to the extent to which your bodily ego is lined up and in sync with your spiritual ego. When things in your life are wrong (i.e., out of alignment), when you live your life in a **wrong environment** (violent, toxic, non-supportive, neglectful), when you engage in **wrong action** (harming others, harming yourself), and when you fill your brain with **wrong thought** (old energy archetypes, violent/negative thoughts, etc.),⁴¹ things can become quite uncomfortable for your bodily ego, particularly when your spiritual ego is present, because when your spiritual ego is present, awareness is enhanced. As we have seen, this enhanced awareness brings the lack of alignment into clear view. This awareness also, as we have seen, heightens the discomfort and pain caused by disjunctive emotions, which can become quite severe over time. Your bodily ego will do anything it can to reduce that pain. It will push the spiritual ego away wilfully. If it cannot push the spiritual ego away wilfully, and if awareness reduction mechanisms are insufficient, your bodily ego may even, as we have seen, turn to drugs and alcohol (i.e., crown stupifiers) to reduce painful awareness. Note that lack of alignment is exacerbated by lack of preparation and bodily ego damage.

That is about all we have to say about alignment. Your understanding should be relatively complete at this point. Before

⁴¹For more on wrong thought, wrong environment, and wrong action, see the the LP course [LP 135 – An Introduction to Wrong Thought](#).

closing up here, however, there are a few more things to say.

Number one, keep in mind that LP concepts of right environment/wrong environments, right action/wrong action, right thought/wrong thought are not moral concepts. They do not refer to some authoritative point of reference, like a moral, patriarch God, which you must obey simply because. These are technical concepts only. Think of them like maintenance rules. If you want your vehicle to run properly, you do not put sugar in the gas tank and you do not let it run without oil. Doing so would be wrong action and would lead to vehicle damage. It is the same with your physical unit, your body. If you want it to run properly, you must avoid doing wrong things to it, like feeding it junk food (wrong action), exposing it to toxic people (wrong environment), and filling its mind with disempowering and debilitating ideas (wrong thought). If you want it to run properly, do the right things for technical, not moral, reasons.

Number two, we want to say, of the three Rs, right environment, right action, and right thought, *achieving right thought is the most important and the hardest*. In order to establish right thought, we have to

- a) examine the ideas and archetypes currently in our brain *and*
- b) replace these ideas with something new, with something empowering, emancipating, and right.

Both of these are major challenges. It can be a challenge even examining the ideas and archetypes in our brain because

- 1) These ideas were introduced to us when we were children and could not think for ourselves, and
- 2) Over the years, they have been constantly reinforced by parents, teachers, and others (Hollywood, the news, writers, artists, etc.) to the point where they are so deeply buried and ingrained as to be perceived by you (and others) as sacred and inviolable. Depending on the particular flavour of your indoctrination, you might even aggressively and defensively resist critical examination.

Even if we do manage to take a critical stance, even if we do realize there is something wrong with our ideas and we want to change, it can be a challenge replacing the ideas. What do you replace them with? As we will see in *LP Workbook Four*, old energy ideas, old energy archetypes, are pervasive. All traditional religions have been polluted with them and modern secular culture is inundated as well. Everywhere you look you find the same ideas. When you start to question, you find no real alternatives. So, where do you even start?

An example might make the difficulties clear. Consider the notions of justice, judgment, and karma, for example. Many people in the world believe in the notion that if you do a bad thing or a good thing, “the universe” or God will cause a bad bad thing or a good to happen to you in return—that is cosmic

justice/karma. For many, this is a sacred concept that they “know” deep in their gut to be true. But what if I told you that concept is pure propaganda? What if I said that God or the universe does not operate that way, that these are elite concepts used to justify power, privilege, and the exploitation and suppression of the masses. If you are one of the people who has been raised to believe in these concepts, if you are one that has been repeatedly exposed to these concepts in art, literature, music, and film, you might experience all sorts of cognitive and emotional stress as you process my statement “It is all a bunch of bullshit.” You might even get so flustered at this idea that you get angry, put down this book and never return. And even if you don’t, even if you can countenance the idea that it is complete bullshit, what then? What do you replace the ideas with? If you look at every religion, you find the same ideas of karma and justice. If you look in books, if you watch movies, if you read into Wicca, they all say the same thing—the universe has an underlying mystical/magical principle that ensures we all get what we deserve.

So where do you start and what do you do?

Well, you could do it yourself. Just as I, you are perfectly capable of making a strong connection and sorting it out for yourself. The only problems with that are,

1. **It can be time consuming.** It is not just ideas of karma

and justice/judgment you have to examine. As we will see in LP Workbook Four, there are lots of other old energy archetypes and ideas that you have to examine and replace. It is an understatement to say it can be time-consuming to sort it all out in a sensible way. If you have a family, a full-time job, and a life it can be almost impossible to find the time you need.

2. **The process is prone to error.** Even when you have identified all the old energy ideas and archetypes that need to be replaced, even if you do come up with some alternatives, the process is prone to error. It is very easy to let old energy ideas inadvertently slide in. To avoid that, you have to have a solid ground. If you do not have that then, like so many other well-meaning people, you will accidentally duplicate old ideological frameworks. If you do that, you have wasted your precious time.
3. Finally, beyond the time-consuming and error-prone nature of the process, **the process is also prone to corruption and interference.** Agents of the Accumulating Class work hard to subvert critical insight and undermine attempts to come up with true alternatives. You can see them operating historically as they colonize and take over authentic spiritual teachings⁴² and you can

⁴²For the scholarship that supports this statement, see Mike Sosteric, “From Zoroaster

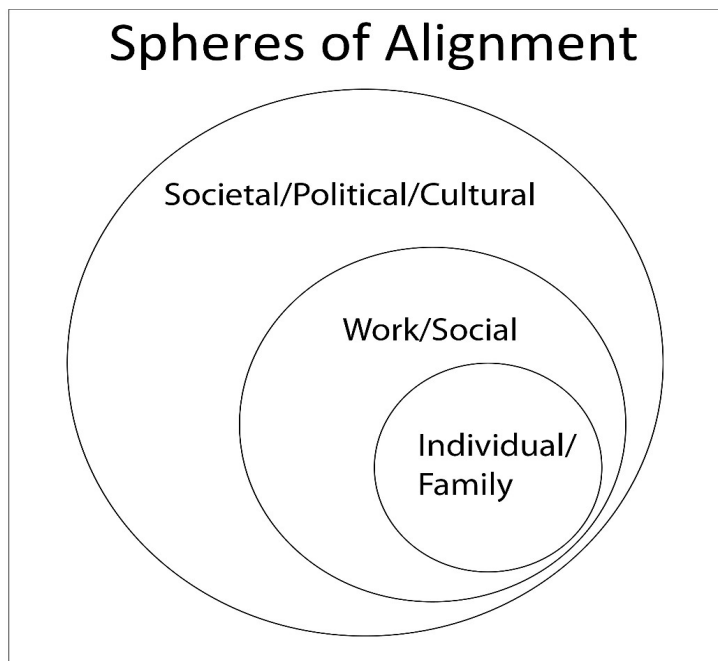
see them operating in contemporary plain site where they frantically write books, do Ted Talks, and create Youtube videos disseminating old energy ideas, and where they interfere in and subvert spiritual discussions in online forums like *r/spirituality*.

Still, despite all the difficulties, it has to be done. You can establish right environment and right action all you want, but if you do not establish right thought you will be unable to maintain powerful, pure, and persistent connections. As long as wrong thought permeates your consciousness, you will struggle to maintain a strong connection.

If this all seems overwhelming, the LP can help. The LP provides an entire workbook and section of the website devoted to exposing old energy ideas and archetypes and replacing them with LP-designed new energy archetypes. When you complete this workbook and are ready to explore that, move on to intermediate level archetype study on the website and in *LP Workbook Four: Archetypal Study*. I am sure you will find these resources will greatly speed the process of establishing right thought.

to Star Wars, Jesus to Marx: The Art, Science, and Technology of Human Manipulation” (Under Review), <https://www.academia.edu/34504691>; Mike Sosteric, “A Sociology of Tarot,” *Canadian Journal of Sociology* 39, no. 3 (2014), <https://www.academia.edu/25055505/>; Mike Sosteric, “Rethinking the Origins and Purpose of Religion: Jesus, Constantine, and the Containment of Global Revolution,” *Athens Journal of Social Sciences* 9, no. 1 (2020): 69–88, https://www.academia.edu/34970150/Rethinking_the_Origins_and_Purpose_of_Religion_Jesus_Constantine_and_the_Containment_of_Global_Revolution.

Finally, the third and last thing I want to say before closing up this unit is that when we talk about alignment, we are not talking about just aligning our individual environment, thought, and behaviour, we are also talking about aligning family environments, work and social environments, work/social environments, and societal/political/cultural environments as well. Ultimately, if we want to establish pure and consistent connection, we have to align the entire world, otherwise we will all be stuck in our homes forever.



To conceptualize this wider process of alignment, we cast alignment into ever-widening spheres **Spheres of Alignment**.⁴³ Spheres of Alignment are personal and collective life spaces within which an individual interested in connection must work to achieve alignment.

These spheres are progressive. When you start working on healing and connection, you start with the individual sphere, which is just you

and the spaces that you have personal influence over, like your home, or your room. When you have achieved alignment in

⁴³Spheres of your reality or, more properly **Spheres of Alignment** are the personal and collective life spaces within which you must achieve both internal and external alignment. See https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Spheres_of_Alignment.

these spaces, and when you begin to connect and gain strength, you move out from your room into your family and social network and begin working on achieving alignment there. Working on your family and social network is harder than establishing individual alignment because, as we have seen, people may feel threatened and resist. Depending on how much resistance there is, you can keep trying or, if it looks like a hopeless cause, you can (and should) avoid further trauma to yourself by finding a new family, a “chosen family,” and new friends more in alignment with you.⁴⁴

As you make progress on the individual and social/familial spheres of alignment, as you gain strength, your next step is to work on the larger societal, political, and cultural spheres. How you do that is entirely up to you. You can draw a progressive comic, work to eliminate racism and sexism, get a job as a social worker, donate your time to fight homelessness, write a progressive spiritual blog, translate LP works, or whatever. Pay attention to your inner guide and do what you are called to do. It is important. At a certain point in our individual development, we are all called to contribute to aligning the wider social, economic, and political spheres. If you do not do that when you are called, you will experience disjuncture and you find connection difficult

⁴⁴“Facing Isolation, Some LGBTQ Parents Create Loving ‘Chosen Families,’” HuffPost Canada, November 12, 2018, https://www.huffingtonpost.ca/2018/11/12/chosen-families-lgbtq_a_23587267/; Brianna Sharpe, “‘Chosen Families’ Give LGBTQ Parents And Kids The Support They May Lack,” *Huffpost*, 2018.

to maintain.

If you are thinking that this is a big call to action, you are correct. Even aligning the limited sphere of your own life can be a challenge. If you do feel overwhelmed by the enormity of the task of aligning the wider spheres, remember these three things:

1. you do not have to do it all yourself
2. you do not have to do it alone
3. it is going to get easier over time.

As noted in the BOL, whether they realize it or not, everybody on this planet is going through a process of rapid awakening, activation, and reconnection. As more and more people awaken, become accountable, atone, as more people work to align their own lives, they will be called in the same way you will be called, to align their lives and this world. If you struggle with alignment now, do what you can in whatever limited capacity you can manage and be patient. As more people come online, it will get easier over time.

And that brings us to an end of this section on alignment. To summarize, lack of alignment leads to a push-pull that makes connection difficult. When your body thinks and acts in an unaligned fashion, your spiritual ego will pull away from the body in order to avoid causing itself and the body it inhabits pain and unnecessary discomfort. It will also pull away to power down its dangerous physical unit. On the other hand, when the body is

not aligned, your bodily ego will find connection painful, difficult to handle, and (if damaged by toxic socialization) discombobulating and possibly dangerous. In these conditions, the bodily ego will push the spiritual ego away. When you put all this together, you can see that lack of alignment is a serious obstacle to forward movement. Nevertheless, as difficult as it may be, you have to align, first in your individual sphere, and then (as possible) in your family, work, and wider societal spheres. Individual alignment is simply not enough. If you want to create a world where we can all enjoy permanent connection, if we want to create the conditions for **graduation** (more on this in the next LP Workbook), we have no choice; we have to align the world.

Study Questions

1. According to the text, *alignment* is the most important concept in the LP corpus. Using information provided in the whole unit, in your own words, describe why this concept is so important. How does the concept of alignment relate to LP concept of authentic spirituality? Do you feel that you are aligned? If not, identify misalignments.
2. What are the Three Rs and the Three Ws of alignment. Briefly explain each.
3. What are the reasons the bodily ego can *push* consciousness away. Examine your own life and any connection events you

might have had. Can you think of examples where you yourself have pushed awareness away? What were your reasons for doing that?

4. What are the three reasons provided in the text why your spiritual might pulled away from the physical unit? Once again, examine your life. Do you feel that there are areas in your life where Consciousness may have pulled away? Write them down and share.
5. What are the spheres of alignment? Why are they important.

Activation

So far in this workbook, we have discussed awakening, accountability, atonement, and alignment as points in the LP Connection Framework.

As we have seen, in order to progress towards connection, **you** must make progress on all these points. You must wake up, be accountable for your actions, atone for any harm **you** have done to others, and seek perfect alignment with your own spiritual ego. Doing all this allows the bodily ego to avoid painful disjuncture and it allows the spiritual ego to comfortably seat itself in its own physical unit.

It is important to note that **you** do not have to be perfect on all points right out of the gate, nor do you have to pursue the points in a linear fashion. **You** can awaken a bit, align a bit, become accountable here and there, awaken a bit more, etc. It is, as indicated in the [Triumph of Spirit Archetype Initiation](#) archetype,⁴⁵ an iterative/spiral process of lifting yourself (and others) up. **Note**, however, if you wish to continue moving forward towards greater connection, you have to make continual progress on each of the points until you achieve **perfection**. Do not pretend you are moving forward or climbing up when you are not. If you stall, you stall, and no amount of self-delusional make-believe will make it otherwise.

Speaking of continuation, assuming at this point that you are working diligently to awaken, atone, align, etc., at some point you are going to begin to feel a push to **activate**. At first, the push will be gentle, like a light tap on your shoulder telling you it is time to stand up and step forward. If you **do not** respond to the initial prompt to activate, the

⁴⁵<https://www.lightningpath.org/lightning-rod/intermediate-c/tosas-cards/initiation/>

push will become a more insistent and bothersome poking that will make you feel “not right,” and that will bother you throughout your day. Finally, if you steadfastly refuse to activate, the push will turn into uncomfortable shoving and painful disjuncture which will not stop until you stand up and activate.

Power and Purpose

Of course, the question at this point is, what does it mean to activate? That is easy. Activation is about two things. It is about

- a) activating your **full power** and
- b) stepping forward to clean up the mess so you can live your **true purpose** for incarnating on this Earth.

Understand that activation is not something mystical or magical.

Activation is something that flows automatically from the awakening and clearing that goes on as part of connection practice. Activation is what happens naturally when you wake up in a filthy, chaotic room. When you are asleep, you do not notice the grime and chaos; however, when you wake up, suddenly you notice the grime and the chaos. Once you become aware of the mess, once you are awake enough to move, you naturally want to clean up the mess around you. This natural and automatic reaction is the activation process.

The activation that naturally occurs in the morning when you wake up is also the activation that occurs on a path of authentic spirituality. When you practice an authentic spirituality, it causes

you to connect. This connection leads to awakening and this awakening inevitably and automatically leads to awareness of the mess that surrounds you (i.e., the presence of exploitation, violence, abuse, etc.). As you become more aware of the toxic and abusive mess that surrounds you, as you gradually step into your waking power, you naturally move to clean up the mess. Spiritual activation is also about waking up to the mess around you and then stepping into your power so you can clean up and, finally, step forward to your true purpose for incarnating on this Earth, which is the work of evolving, healing and, reconnecting the planet in order to create a garden paradise for all, what we call [The Great Work](#).⁴⁶

Understand, what you clean up first and how you help with the Great Work is entirely up to you. You can do many things in many different orders. Maybe you are a masseuse touching people to help relieve their stress. Maybe you are a teacher teaching the next generation. Maybe you are a healer helping to heal physical and mental illness. Maybe you are an empath helping to heal emotional pain. Maybe you are a farmer, bringing nutritious food to the world. Maybe you are a parent raising a healthy and strong next generation. Maybe you are a writer offering people entertainment or new ways to think. Maybe you are a musician sending messages of truth and love. It does not really matter. There are a lot of ways to help, lots of ways to empower, and lots of ways to uplift humanity. Only you know the specifics of what

⁴⁶https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/The_Great_Work

you are here to do, so only you can figure out what activation means for you. Just know this. Whatever it is, it is not work. Whatever it is, it is something that you *love* to do.

This is very important.

Understand, you are not here on this plant to suffer in some assembly line. You are not here to be a slave to some corporation or government. You are not here to submit to economic, political, or social exploitation. You are here to uplift life by doing something you love to do, something that makes you happy, something that makes you feel proud of the contribution you are making, something that brings light, love, and power to others. If you love having sex all the time, maybe you are a sex worker. If you love the biology of the human body, or love working with people's emotional life, then maybe you are a healer of some sort. If you love exercise and fitness, maybe you are a personal trainer. If you love research, maybe you are a scientist. If you love administration, maybe you are a CEO working to transform the System. If you love children, then maybe you should be a parent, or a child care worker, or something that helps educate and uplift children.

And that is activation. Activation is what happens when you wake up, atone, align, and finally begin to connect with and express the powerful spiritual ego inside. Activation is embracing your power and purpose so that you can clean up the mess and complete the Great Work.

For your information, activation is depicted



visually in the Triumph of Spirit [Power Archetype](#).⁴⁷ The Power archetype shows you the consequences of full activation, which is empowerment. The card also shows you the negative consequences on those that surround. You will be learning more about the Triumph of Spirit Archetype System (TOSAS) in the next *LP Workbook Four*.

Activation Challenges

We have to say, activation is a big deal. Activation joyfully connects you with your power and purpose, but it is also a major challenge. It is a major challenge for you and it is a major challenge for those around you.

As regards the challenge for you, think of it like this. Imagine that your body is a powerful red sports car. A Ferrari, let's say, with 600+ horsepower and a performance-tuned system. Right now, you are sitting in that high-performance vehicle with the engine on, but for some reason, you are not pressing the gas pedal. While idling, you are able to move around a bit, but you cannot get anywhere very fast. Then one day somebody comes along and after a brief exchange of niceties says, "Oh and by the way, if you want to go faster, press that pedal." You do and all of a sudden the powerful engine wakes up and you go blasting forward.

What happens when you press the gas pedal the first time depends on a lot of different things. Maybe you manage to get going safely. Maybe, you do not. Maybe you hit the gas pedal a little too hard the first time. Maybe, as a consequence, you lose control and smash into a tree or another car. Maybe you are so freaked out by the power of the vehicle

⁴⁷<https://www.lightningpath.org/lightning-rod/power>

that you reach up and turn off the ignition while you try and collect your wits. The point here is, the first time you hit the gas pedal of a supercar, you may be surprised and unprepared for the power.

Activation in the spiritual sense is like that. When you activate, it is like slamming down on the gas pedal of a high-performance vehicle. When you do that, the **power** goes *shocking* through you. If you are not ready, if you are not careful, if you are not properly prepared, you may have a hard time controlling the power that suddenly becomes available. You might be surprised at the things that happen as a result. If you are not careful, you might even hurt yourself and others.

This is the challenge for you. The challenge is handling the awesome power of the high-performance vehicle your **spiritual ego** has incarnated into.

If this freaks you out a bit, chill. All the LP material you have read so far on healing and connection, all the advice on awakening, accountability, atonement, and alignment, and all the material on archetypes we cover later in *LP Workbook Four*, is all the safety and driver training you need in order to “step on the gas” and get moving **forward at power**. If you have been paying attention and putting into practice the things **you have been learning**, you should be fine. If not, or if you **feel** you have missed some stuff, follow your intuition and go back and read the materials again.

As noted, handling the power of an activated physical unit can be a **challenge for you**. In addition to the problems associated with actually dealing with an activated physical unit, **you may also have a hard time believing the power is real**. After all, you have probably

never been told the truth about your **spiritual ego** and its physical unit. On the contrary, you have probably been told lies that diminish your spiritual ego and your physical unit. From day one, from birth, you have been told about your dirty, sinful, animal nature. You are a primitive violent ape, a broken and sinful soul sent down to Earth to learn karmic “lessons.” You are a “reject from the Garden.” You are filled with original sin. You are nothing more than a slightly evolved chimpanzee, a violent, competitive, ape. You are a neophyte, untrained and incapable. You are an unfit pathetic loser. You are nothing more than “dust in the wind.” Having been filled up with this putrid nonsense, when you press down on the gas pedal, you may be taken aback by the reality of the power that is revealed by the activation. You may deny. You may resist. You may doubt. Filled with religious and scientific superstition, afraid that you might not be worthy, and terrified that you may be unable to “handle” all that power, you may even succumb to fear of losing your mind or losing control.⁴⁸

The self-doubt that can occur as a consequence of all the negative ideology of self you have been fed makes activation hard. If you doubt your worthiness, if you are terrified that you **cannot** handle the power, if you succumb to fear, **you will** take your foot off the gas and perhaps feel too unworthy or too scared to try again. If that happens, you live

⁴⁸A lot of effort is put into sowing doubt and fear into your mind and consciousness. Consider the old Hollywood movie *The Sphere*. In this movie, actors find a “sphere” deep in the ocean. Contact with the sphere gives them incredible power, so much so that everything they think about comes true in reality around them. Unfortunately, it turns out they cannot control their thoughts and feelings. All their unconscious “darkness” blows up in the world around them as the sphere manifests their inner dark. Slowly, their own thoughts destroy them. Eventually they realize just how stupid and incompetent they are. At the end of the movie, they are seen using the unlimited power of the sphere to wish the power away, and wish themselves back to sleep. The sphere descends into the ocean and they go back to their “normal,” powerless existence. The moral, you cannot handle the power so reject it and go back to sleep.

your life out in the chronic diminishment of “normal.” Do not let that happen. If you are startled or in fear of the power that is unleashed, take a deep breath and repeat these words, “I can do it.” Take your time, do the work, prepare, practice, and you will be just fine. If you stumble, breathe, recuperate, and try again.

To summarize, activating can be a challenge for you. When you activate, you may find yourself startled and unprepared for the power. You may also experience challenges like fear, self-doubt, and confusion. Remember, activating means confronting your full power and purpose, and that can be a challenge. You can do it, however, if you just pay attention and prepare.

The challenges noted above are the internal challenges you experience when you activate your power and purpose. They are the fears and resistances that emerge as a consequence of lack of preparation, ideology, and so on. There can also be external challenges to activation. External challenges specifically arise from the people that surround you, and this for a couple of different reasons.

For one, with awakening comes awareness of problems and a deep desire to change things. With activation comes the desire and the power to make those things happen. When you activate, you will push for change. On a healthy planet, that would not be an issue. However, on Earth, there are many people who are sick, afraid of change, and comfortable with the status quo. These people will feel threatened by your awareness and your push for change and they will often do whatever they can to

suppress and prevent that change from happening. Power up and try to emancipate yourself, and the people who hurt you, oppress you, exploit you, or otherwise benefit in some way from your somnambulism, are going to lash out and try and push you back down.

We see this all the time. Patriarchs, for example, will feel uncomfortable as their wives specifically, or women in general, advance forward into their true purpose and power. They will push back, often resorting to physical, psychological, emotional, political, or sexual violence against activation. We see this happening on the planet right now. Male managers are leading a backlash against women and the #MeToo movement by withdrawing their support in a passive-aggressive fashion.⁴⁹ In the United States, conservative actors are systematically stripping women of their rights. In some countries, women may be the targets of violence, even assassination. Consider, for example, Tara Fares, an Instagram model and activist in Baghdad who was assassinated by drive-by shooters while sitting in the vehicle of her car.⁵⁰

Politicians and the rich will also have a problem with your activation. Politicians who work for the rich and support the old energy System, and the rich themselves, will feel uncomfortable when people start to awaken, activate, and change things. As their citizens advance towards emancipation and full power, they will push back.

Part of the push back will be psychological and emotional. The

⁴⁹“Me Too Backlash Is Getting Worse,” HuffPost Canada, May 17, 2019, https://www.huffpost.com/entry/me-too-backlash-getting-worse_n_5cddd96de4b00e035b8ce786.

⁵⁰Google *Tara Fares* for news and analysis.

media's power to indoctrinate will be exploited in full measure. Efforts will be expended to stop re-activation of the people by dumbing them down and re-indoctrinate them.

Part of the push back will be military. If psychological and emotional manipulation does not work to stop individual and global activation, police and, finally, military force will be used. This is not open to argument. History has demonstrated over and over again that political and economic elites will not willingly release their power and privilege to an activating population. They will use whatever means is at their disposal, including genocidal violence, to ensure they retain their power and privilege. We are seeing this quite clearly right now. Since the election of Donald Trump in the United States, conservative elites the world over are increasingly inciting division and violence, and increasingly pushing authoritarian changes in order to suppress progressive action and turn back the awakening. As more and more people awaken and activate, the violence will escalate. The end game for them is, as it has been in the past, world war and, if necessary, nuclear destruction. The uber-rich are addicts. They will not willingly let go of their power. They will violently resist activation.

To summarize, people who are sick, people who are afraid of change, people who are comfortable with the status quo, will feel a challenge when people activate and they will lash out and try to prevent and

suppress the transformation and change that necessarily ensues. It will happen every time. It is simply the nature of the beast.

So, what do *you* do? What do *we* do as we collectively awaken and activate? Certainly, we cannot just ignore and pretend and continue on business as usual. If **we** do that, we are not waking up, we are not activating, and we will not be able to achieve a pure and persistent connection. At the same time, we cannot run willy-nilly into the fray, else we risk triggering an even more violent backlash that will harm us and shut the process down. Instead, be careful. Take measured and considered steps. Understand, you will get push back from spouses, family, friends, coworkers, managers, and even government forces. Do not let that stop you, but do not foolishly ignore the inevitable reaction. Protect yourself against assault. Push for change, but do so without violence, judgment, and condemnation. If you run around angrily wagging judgmental fingers at all the people who have oppressed and suppressed you, you will only trigger their defences. As a planet, we need to activate and we need to effect change, but we need to effect that change in an inclusive manner. Activation needs to lead to healing and reconciliation, not judgment and condemnation.

Of course, be realistic. Sometimes, conciliatory pushes for change do not work. You might live in an abusive household and you may try to make change by, for example, pushing violent members to stop or get treatment for their behaviours. In an attempt to suppress change, they may lash out violently no

matter what you do. Do not reciprocate the violence. Instead, exit the home environment and create your own safe place. This goes for your home environment, your work environment, and in fact all life spheres within which you move. If you activate and try and change and if that push elicits violent backlash, build your life up somewhere else if you can.

Before closing off this section, one final comment is in order and that is simply this, just like awakening, acknowledgement, atonement, and alignment are required if you want to achieve persistent and pure connection, activation is required as well. If you want to connect, you have to activate and you have to use your power and purpose to make positive changes in your life spheres. We are not saying anything novel here. As discussed in the book *Rocket Scientists Guide to Authentic Spirituality*, activation has always been an important part of authentic spiritual paths. It is actually an extension of the alignment process. The more your spiritual ego enters into the body, the more you become who you truly are deep down inside. Since deep down inside you are a being of light, life, compassion, love, and *power*, the more you become who you are, the more you are going to want to change things for the better, and the more you will feel empowered to do so. If you do not, then you are not aligned with your spiritual ego. If you are not aligned with your spiritual ego, you might be able to accomplish temporary

connections here and there, but you will not be able to take the next step which is ascension and permanent reconnection with your spiritual ego. If you do not take the next step, then you will inevitably return to a self-deluded and diminished normal consciousness where you will find yourself making excuses for your inaction and pretending you are powerful, connected, and spiritual when in fact you are not. Do not let that happen to you. When you get to the point of activation, find a way to make change, however small and insignificant it might be. Always remember this, even small initial changes can lead to complete life transformations in due time.

Study questions

1. In the unit, we say activation is about purpose and power. Purpose is something you love to do, that uplifts the planet and its people in some way. Right now, spend some time thinking about what you love to do? Do you love painting? Do you love gardening? Do you love teaching? Do you love research? Do you love working with your hands? Do you love sex? Right down your loves and reflect. Are you working towards a life of doing what you love, or are you stuck in somebody else's purpose?
2. There are many ways to actuate your purpose, some which are in alignment with your **spiritual ego**, and some which are not. If you love teaching, for example, you can teach truth or you can be involved in seeding ideology and misconception. If you

love administration, you can use that power to uplift others, or you can use it in service to The System. If you love building things, you can be involved in building instruments of war or building houses for the poor. Ask yourself the question, are you currently “living your purpose” and if you are, is that purpose aligned with your spiritual ego. If you are not living your purpose in an aligned fashion, what sorts of adjustments can you make to bring your life work into better alignment.

3. As noted in this unit, stepping into your power can be a challenging process. There are internal challenges as well as external challenges. Think back on your life now. Have you experienced internal activation challenges, like self-doubt, surprise at your own power, fear, confusion, etc. How about external **activation challenges**? Have you tried to stand up and empower only to be pushed back down? If so, by whom. Strategize to yourself, and share in this response, how to move forward, stay empowered, and make positive change.

Ascension

At this point, we have discussed five of the LP Connection Framework focus points, awakening, accountability, atonement, alignment, and activation. As noted, these points do not represent a linear connection sequence but circular/spiral path. Focus on one or the other as you feel drawn to it. If you feel you need to awaken a bit, do that. If you have some atonement to do, do that. If your life is out of alignment, make adjustments as necessary. If you feel called to change something, do that. Throughout this process, follow your gut. Do what feels right when it feels right to do it and you will make progress forward. With that said, in this unit we are going to complete our examination of the LP Connection Framework by looking at the final focus point, ascension. The question before us now is, what is ascension?

At its most basic level, at the level of discrete short-term connection events, which is the level we will be concerned with in this workbook, ascension is just another word for connection. More specifically, **ascension** is what happens when your bodily ego and spiritual ego connect. When that happens, when you make a connection, your bodily ego “ascends” to meet the bright and powerful spiritual ego, at which point it has some sort of verbal or visual conversation with it. To be clear, when you connect your bodily ego to your spiritual ego, ideas and images from the spiritual ego enter into [The Flow](https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/The_Flow)⁵¹ of your mind. When the connection experience is complete, the bodily ego then “descends” back down into normal consciousness as communication tapers off. After the connection experience is complete, the bodily ego, the mind, then takes the time it needs process, integrate, and ground

⁵¹https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/The_Flow

what it has learned as a consequence of the enhanced flow that occurs during the connection.

This is not a real ascent of course. Your body does not float up into the sky to meet some angels, though you can certainly visualize this happening. What is really happening is you are engaging in a form of information exchange. Your connection has opened up a channel, so to speak. However, unless your connection experience is a [Nadir Experience](#),⁵² in which case it can feel like you are descending into hell fire, it does often feel like an ascent, like you are rising up to meet something bigger, more powerful, and more grand than your normal little self. This feeling of being uplifted is why the word ascension is used so often in the spiritual literature of the planet to describe the thoughts and feelings associated with connection. It is also why ascent is a common theme in mystical writing and mystical paintings.

Note that we can also talk about connection in terms of a descent, as in your Spiritual Ego *descends* into the vessel and connects with the bodily ego. In the Kabbalah, this process is conceived of as a “Descent to the Chariot,”⁵³ or in LP terms as descent into the vessel. In Christian terminology, this is the descent of the Holy Spirit.⁵⁴ When we think of

⁵²Remember, a nadir experience is a negatively perceived connection experience.
https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Nadir_Experience

⁵³Joseph Dan, *Kabbalah: A Very Short Introduction* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2006).

⁵⁴For example, Luke 3: 20-25 notes the baptism/initiation of Jesus involved the descent of the Holy Spirit, “like a dove.” Similarly, Jesus is able to initiate connection in others, i.e., the descent of the Holy Spirit, by his very presence.

Peace be with you! As the Father has sent me, I am sending you.” And with that he breathed on them and said, “Receive the Holy Spirit.”

the process of connection as a descent, the process becomes “filling the vessel” with the water of Consciousness, as portrayed in the LP Water Glass Metaphor.⁵⁵

In the final analysis, it does not matter how you look at it, either as ascent of the bodily ego into “heaven” (i.e. high connection) or descent of spiritual ego into the body (i.e. descent into the vessel). Either way, the same process of connection between spiritual ego and bodily ego is being referred to. When we make a connection, we unite with spiritual ego, open an information channel, and have a connection experience of some sort.

Healing, Preparation, Intention, Connection Practice

So, how do you achieve ascension? How do you achieve a pure and persistent connection? How do you fill the vessel with consciousness? How do you achieve union? It is just like anything really. It takes preparation and practice. Specifically, you have to

- a) heal the body and mind,
- b) prepare your inner and outer spaces,
- c) intend, and finally
- d) engage in connection practice.

Healing

As for healing, healing is required because the bodily ego takes a lot of damage from the toxic socialization process we all endure. A healthy bodily ego, a strong and secure bodily ego, is necessary if you want to

⁵⁵https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Water_Glass_Metaphor

handle your own powerful higher Consciousness. A damaged bodily ego struggles with that power. Therefore, if you want to unite the bodily ego and spiritual ego, you have to heal.

We will not talk about the healing process in this workbook. The LP provides the **LP HEALING Framework** to help with this important preparatory step. You can find this HEALING Framework in [*Lightning Path*](#)⁵⁶ and also in the Foundational teachings on the Lightning Path website. If you have not already read through *LP Workbook Two* and visited the LP site, we recommend you do that right now before proceeding any further.

Preparing Your Inner and outer Spaces

In addition to healing you also have to prepare your inner and outer spaces. You have to “prepare the way” we might say. This part of the preparation can be complicated because it involves significant conceptual and behavioural revisions. To prepare, you have to have to awaken to the truths in your life and in your society, become accountable for your actions, atone for the bad shit you have done, establish right environment, right action, and right thought, and finally activate/empower so you make necessary changes. It is a lot of work and can take a lot of time, especially if you bump up against resistance. Thankfully however, and as you no doubt realize at this point, we have been “preparing the way” throughout this workbook. If you have read through this workbook, you have been following the **Lightning Path Connection Framework**. The LP Connection Framework provides guidance on how to prepare your inner and outer

⁵⁶<https://www.lightningpath.org/lightning-rod/connection-coach/lp-workbooks/>

spaces. If you have been following the LP and reading this workbook, you have already gone a long way towards properly preparing for your connection and union with your spiritual ego. You are not done yet, of course, because there is still work to do, but if you are reading these words and putting into practice what you have been learning, then you have already come a long way.

Intention

As noted above, in order to prepare for connection you have to heal and you have to prepare the way. As with all things in life, you also have to intend your way forward. If you want to get up in the morning, you have to intend to get up. If you want to make breakfast, you have to intend to make breakfast. If you want to open your hands and pick up a fork, you have to intend that to happen.

As noted in the SpiritWiki entry on **intent**,⁵⁷ intent is a common factor in spiritual practice. Indeed, all connection frameworks come with advice on intent, though often it is couched in “mysterious” trappings and sometimes not recognized as such. To be as clear as possible, *if you want to ascend and connect with your spiritual ego, you have to intend that connection.*

As with healing and preparing the way, if you have been following along with the LP training then you have already come across materials on initiating connection, like the section on

⁵⁷<https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Intent>

[Understanding and Initiation Connection](#)⁵⁸ at the LP Foundational level of study, and the materials on affirmation in *Lightning Path Workbook One*, so you should already know the basics. Here we will just introduce you to a slightly more advanced affirmation and visualization that goes beyond mere *awakening* and point towards full activation and ascension/union of spiritual ego and bodily ego. To help focus your intent on activation and union, use a **Connection Affirmation**⁵⁹ like this...

I wish to wake up. I wish to move forward,
I wish to activate. I wish to connect. (repeat x4).

As you recite this affirmation, amplify your intent by visualizing yourself lying down and sleeping. You open your eyes, look around the room, stand up, get dressed, clean up any messes, leave the home, and go out and change the world for the better in some fashion. If you want to get really spiritual, use the following to initiate and affirm your desire to connect.

Visualize the consciousness of your body as a small ball of light rising up and leaving your body through the top of your head. Visualize this consciousness ascending up into a clear blue sky. Visualize a door high above. Visualize your consciousness rising up to that door. When you get there, open the door and move through it. On the other side of it, there is a being of bright light and

⁵⁸<https://www.lightningpath.org/foundations/the-basics/>

⁵⁹https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Connection_Affirmation

power. This is your own Highest Self, your own soul. Approach yourself, stand in front of your Self, and greet your Self. Did you come with a question or questions? Then ask your Self the questions.

Finally, if you want, you can also use the advanced, official LP *Graduation Invocation*(GI)⁶⁰ although it is perhaps best to complete LP Workbook Four before “invoking the lightning” so to speak.

Affirmations and visualizations are important because they help signal intent and they help steer the process. It is like if you are building a piece of furniture, like a bookcase. If you want to build a bookcase, you do not just cut wood randomly and without some kind of plan. If you did that, you could end up with a bookcase catastrophe. When you go to build a bookcase, you have an idea in your mind about what you want the table to look like. Better yet, you might even have a visual plan, a blueprint, to go by. It is the same with building a connection. Connection affirmations and visualizations are your idea of what you want to happen as you initiate and strengthen your connection. Doing one can help make sure that your connection practice moves forward smoothly and that it does not end up in a catastrophic, even pathological, mess.

Connection Practice

Connection affirmation and connection visualization are important

⁶⁰https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Graduation_Invocation

parts of the ascension process, but they only help up to a point. At some point, if you want to make solid and consistent progress, you will have to engage in some disciplined and systemic

[Connection Practice.](#) ⁶¹

What is connection practice? Connection practice is like soccer practice or guitar practice. When you practice guitar, you sit down every day in a disciplined fashion, do exercises, play scales, run through chord progressions, and play songs. In essence, guitar practice consists of various *components*, techniques, and practice strategies that you use to become a better guitarist. It is the same with connection practice.

Connection practice is the regular and disciplined practice of connection using various techniques and strategies for improvement. The only difference between guitar practice and connection practice is in the things you do. When you practice guitar, you sit down and practice scales, chords, and songs. When you practice connection, you

- a) practice **opening a wider connection** and
- b) practice **handling** that connection.

To practice **opening** a wider connection, combine strong intent with connection techniques, connection supplements, and connection appliances to facilitate opening.

⁶¹https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Connection_Practice

To practice **handling** a connection, you use the LP techniques of flow control and flow purification. Do not worry if you do not understand these just yet, we will deal with them each in their turn starting with connection techniques.

Opening a Connection

The first component of opening a wider connection that we deal with is [Connection Technique](#). Connection techniques are any technique or practice strategy that can help you open a wider connection. There are many different connection techniques you can use, including things like Holotropic Breath work, Drumming, Hypo ventilation, journal writing, Zazen, and so on. On the LP we don't advocate any specific connection practice. Explore, experiment, and find one that feels right and works for you. Descriptions of these various techniques, which are common throughout the world, are available on the [Connection Techniques](#)⁶² SpiritWiki page. You can use that page as a jumping off point to find one that works for you.

As part of your connection practice you can also use [Connection Supplements](#)⁶³ to facilitate stronger connection. Connection supplements are substances and supplements like cannabis, peyote, DMT, or LSD that *force* open a wider connection. Connection supplements are a very efficient way to open and practice your connection and they have been used for thousands of years as such. As anthropologist Michael Harner points out,

⁶²https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Connection_Technique

⁶³https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Connection_Supplements

there is ample evidence to suggest that connection supplements were used to heal and connect throughout the ancient world.⁶⁴ Indeed, in some traditional societies, connection supplements are understood as the powerful and safe supplements they are, and are even taken by the whole family in social gatherings, or given to children who are misbehaving.⁶⁵ For example, the Mazatec indigenous of Oaxaca Mexico use psilocybin mushrooms for connection, and "usually several members of a family eat the mushrooms together: it is not uncommon for a father, mother, children, uncles, and aunts to all participate in these transformations of the mind that elevate consciousness onto a higher plane."⁶⁶

Despite misinformed opposition from conservative elites who would rather see people sick and disconnected, the use of connection supplements for healing and connection represents a growing practice in our modern era, especially as research that reveals their almost magical healing and connection properties continues to proliferate. On the LP we recommend, for at least three reasons, the use of connection supplements.

Number one, we recommend connection supplements because

⁶⁴Michael J Harner, *Hallucinogens and Shamanism* (New York: Oxford University Press, 1973).

⁶⁵Michael J Harner, *The Jivaro: People of the Sacred Waterfalls* (London: Robert Hale & Company, 1972).

⁶⁶Henry Munn, "The Mushrooms of Language," in *Hallucinogens and Shamanism*, ed. Michael J Harner (New York: Oxford University Press, 1973), 86–122.

they are healing. Indigenous traditions the world over use these substances to facilitate healing⁶⁷ and science is rapidly revealing just how important these substances are to human health and well being. Consider cannabis, for example. The human body is literally wired for cannabis. The human body has cannaboid receptors throughout the body and science is revealing more and more the power of this herb to provide emotional, psychological, and even physical healing. By now, we also know that cannabis helps with depression, anxiety, PTSD, and a host of other emotional and psychological problems. There is also, as indicated by [A National Cancer Institute document](#), cites evidence that cannabis can inhibit and even shrink cancerous tumours.⁶⁸ There is also growing research on the healing properties of [psilocybin](#),⁶⁹ [LSD](#),⁷⁰ and other powerful connection supplements.

Number two, we recommend connection supplements because when you are using a connection supplement, you are almost guaranteed to open a connection every time. Being able to efficiently open a connection facilitates regular and disciplined connection practice, something which is very important if you want to make progress. We say almost because even powerful

⁶⁷Harner, *Hallucinogens and Shamanism*.

⁶⁸https://www.cancer.gov/about-cancer/treatment/cam/hp/cannabis-pdq#cit/section_4.15

⁶⁹http://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Psilocybin_Mushroom

⁷⁰<http://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/LSD>

supplements like LSD can be subverted by a bodily ego that is traumatized and too terrified to let go of control. Nevertheless, in most cases, ingesting or inhaling a connection supplement will facilitate/force a connection experience.

Number three, we recommend connection supplements because with them you have better control over the onset, *intensity* and duration of the experience. This gives you the ability to properly plan and structure your connection practice and to *aim* for specific types of connection experiences. Note that the ability to control your experience is primarily true only with medical-grade connection supplements, and not street-level materials. With street supplements, you roll the dice on quality and concentration, whereas with medical-grade supplements, the quality and concentration is carefully controlled, allowing you to experiment with precise dosages. You can go “low and slow” in the beginning when you are just starting out, and you can ingest higher dosages later to experience more powerful connection experiences.

In addition to learning connection techniques and using connection supplements to enhance and practice connection, you can also use various [connection appliances](http://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Connection_Appliance).⁷¹ Connection appliances are any technology that can facilitate, enhance, or help purify one’s connection. Examples here include drums,

⁷¹http://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Connection_Appliance

Tibetan Singing Bowls, quartz crystals, sweat lodges, and even the [LP Triumph of Spirit Archetype Deck](http://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Triumph_of_Spirit_Archetype_Deck),⁷² which is part of the [Triumph of Spirit Archetype System](http://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Triumph_of_Spirit_Archetype_System) (TOSAS).⁷³ The TOSAS, which we will learn about in some detail in *LP Workbook Four*, is a collection of images and commentary designed to help you with open, expand and, in the case of the TOSAS, purify your connection. Use whatever connection appliances you are drawn towards and which feel right for you to use.

Handling a Connection

As noted, to open a wider connection you use connection techniques, connection supplements, and connection appliances. Opening a connection is just a first step, however. Once you open connection, you also have to practice connection. This is because connection opens up a channel to your powerful spiritual ego, and beyond that to a vast ocean of Consciousness that is powerful and that can simply overwhelm. When you open that pipe wide Consciousness, which consists of ideas, images, concepts, visions, etc., flows like a high pressure water through a large hose. If you do not know how to control that flow, you can easily be overwhelmed, even terrified, particularly when you are a neophyte, and particularly when you have been indoctrinated with fear-based archetypes and

⁷²http://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Triumph_of_Spirit_Archetype_Deck

⁷³http://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Triumph_of_Spirit_Archetype_System

theology. Fear-based archetypes theology are archetypes and theology that sow fear deep into the consciousness of its victims. Fear-based theology emphasizes violence, judgment, horrible punishment (like a lifetime of retribution in a karmic “lower birth”), and fiery damnation. In cases where you are overwhelmed and terrified, you can be scarred away from ever trying to open a connection again.

So, what do you do if you cannot handle the flow? Either you stick to low intensity connection techniques like mindfulness where you have lots of cognitive and emotional time and space to process, or you learn connection techniques like **flow control** and **flow purification**, both of which can help you handle the intense flow that can accompany a wide open connection. As a note, there is nothing wrong with using low intensity techniques, unless you are in some kind of hurry because of physical illness, mental distress, etc. However, even if you do focus on low intensity methods, if you make enough progress you will eventually have more powerful experiences. When you do, you will benefit from flow purification and flow control, so you might as well learn them regardless.

Flow Control

As noted, if you want to learn to handle stronger connections, you have to learn flow control and flow purification. Of these, the first and thing you need to do, and the easiest thing to learn, is flow control. Flow

control is basically the ability to stem and get control of the flow of ideas, images, and visions that can attend a wide open connection. Flow controls means being able to slow the flow of ideas and images if they become too overwhelming.

How do you do that? That depends on whether the problem is just intense flow or whether you have negative thoughts and emotions going along with the intense flow. If flow is simply intense, then you basically turn down the flow like you turn the water down on a garden hose. There are two ways to do that.

The first way to stem the flow is by redirecting your attention, by distracting yourself. You can do this by listening to calming music, going for a walk in nature, playing a familiar computer game, or reciting an affirmation/mantra. Any affirmation that helps you affirm your power over the flow will work. Something like “I am strong, I am capable, I can handle the flow” is just fine. Simply repeat until you have got a handle on the powerful energies.

The second way you can engage in flow control is by saying to yourself, to your Consciousness, “slow down,” and then willing the slow down to happen. In this case, you simply assert mental control over your thought processes. Although you might have trouble controlling the flow during your first few powerful connection events, it is possible to do this. Forms of connection practice like transcendental meditation are designed to train you to control the flow.

Now, the above flow control strategies work if the problem is simple intensity of flow. However, if negative ideas (i.e., “I am stupid,” “I am worthless,” “God hates me,” etc.) and negative emotions (i.e., guilt, shame, and fear) are part of your experience, then it can be a little harder to control the flow because these ideas and emotions can

overwhelm your sense of self and sense of control. To get control when negative emotions are at play, you can do two things.

First, face the negativity. Face the negative ideas. Face the guilt, shame, or fear. Facing means acknowledging the ideas or emotions are there and not distracting yourself or otherwise running away from them. If all of a sudden you have a frightening idea that God will punish and damn you, acknowledge that this idea is there. If it is fear you are experiencing, acknowledge that fear. If you are feeling guilt or shame, acknowledge that guilt or shame. Do not deny the thought or emotions. Do not pretend they do not exist. Do not repress them back down. Become aware and acknowledge.

The second thing you can do to get control over negative emotions and ideas is to carefully limit and control the flow of oxygen into the room to make sure you can handle the information that flows with a brighter ego flame. If you are using [Connection Supplements](#), this involves carefully controlling the dosage so that you don't open a connection wider than you can handle. If you are availing yourself of [Connection Practices](#),⁷⁴ this means moderating their use and backing away from practice when things move too fast to handle. If you are doing connection affirmations and connection visualizations and things start to heat up, simply stop or reverse the affirmation. Instead of saying "I wish to connect" say "I need to slow down for a while so I can process."

Once you have faced the negativity, then the next thing you do depends on what ideas or emotions you are facing. In cases where guilt and shame suddenly rise up during your connection experience, you will

⁷⁴http://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Connection_Practice

need to figure out where the guilt and shame is coming from (hint, it is coming from some harmful actions on your part) and then resolve to atone for the bad actions. If you do that, then next time you make a connection you will not have to deal with it. Of course, you cannot atone during the actual connection event, so make a resolution to fix the damage as soon as you can. Say something like, “I know what I did and I promise to make the things right.” Be sincere about this and then when your connection experience is done, make sure you follow through on your promise. If you do not follow through, you will confront guilt and shame again, and it may very well be harder.

Guilt and shame are not the only emotions that can rise up. Confusion and fear can also be issues. Confusion is caused when new and dramatically different ideas enter into the flow in a sudden and intense fashion. In these cases, you can be overwhelmed by novelty and enormity of the information flow. This is especially true when ideas go dramatically against what you already believe. Ideas that we are one with God can cause a lot of anxiety and confusion when they come up against Catholic ideas that we are sinful, ejected rejects. Generally, fear during connection events is caused by negative ideas and archetypes you absorbed from parents, teachers, priests, and other authority figures who tell you stories and give you ideas designed to control how you think. The ideas that cause fear can be religious ideas, like you are a sinful reject from the Garden, or God is going to punish you if you do not follow “his” rules, or there are demons out to get you, or they can be secular ideas, like the idea that the experience of intense flow is going to make you crazy, that flow is primitive. infantile madness,⁷⁵ or

⁷⁵See for example Sigmund Freud, *The Future of an Illusion* (New York: Anchor Books, 1961), <https://amzn.to/2EZqqgZ>.

that you are going to lose touch with reality if you explore too much.⁷⁶

Whatever the ideas are that cause confusion and fear, you have to address them, otherwise you might be traumatized by the connection, develop a connection pathology, or be scared away from further connection practice all together. The best way to do that is to suppress the ideas during connection—simply try not to think them—and then to purify your mind, either during the connection event if you can, or when you are back to normal.

Flow Purification

So how do you deal with ideas that cause fear and confusion, guilt and shame? That is simple, at least in theory. In theory, you deal with all the wrong thought in your head by practising what we call **Flow Purification**.⁷⁷ For your information, flow purification is a connection practice that involves purifying the powerful flow of any ideological and archetypal junk you may have accumulated as a consequence of the indoctrination that occurs during toxic socialization. Ideological and archetype junk, wrong thought, includes archetypal ideas like judgment and punishment, ideas that you are some kind of cosmic school child here to learn lessons, ideas that God is some kind of divine,

⁷⁶To be frank, this is a bit of a danger. It can happen that you can lose your ground and become a little unhinged during and immediately after a connection experience, especially if that experience is powerful, if you are not prepared, and if you have experienced a lot of family violence and trauma as a child and adolescent. In a few very rare cases, psychosis can result. Nevertheless, proper preparation can provide a solid anchor in the ground, and a little bit of post-connection guidance can help bring you back down to Earth.

⁷⁷https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Flow_Purification

authoritarian patriarch, ideas that you are some sort of fool in school here to learn lessons, and so on. Any ideas and archetypes that diminish you and make you less than the joyful and masterful spark of creator consciousness that you are, any ideas that cause you intense guilt, shame, anxiety, fear, and paranoia, any ideas that corrupt or twist the Flow are junk ideas that have to be removed.

How do you engage in flow purification? How do you remove wrong thought and old energy archetypes? We talk about this in much more detail in *LP Workbook Four* and on the website. Here I will just say you do that in a three-step process of **recognize, root out, and replace**.⁷⁸ Basically, **recognize** the limiting ideas and ideologies that have been implanted in your consciousness and that disconnect and corrupt your Flow; then, **root** these ideas out by consciously examining them until you are clear about what they are. Finally, make a decision and **replace** those archetypes and ideas that you do not want to keep with new, life-affirming new ideas and archetypes.

This process of flow purification is simple to conceptualize and absolutely essential if you want to make forward progress towards pure and strong connection; however, the process of recognize, root out, and replace can be very difficult to put into practice, and this for at least three reasons.

⁷⁸https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Recognize,_root_out,_and_replace

The first reason it can be difficult to practice flow purification because we are not taught, as a rule, to examine the ideas in our brains. Rather, we are taught to just accept whatever was poured and implanted into us when we were children. Because we were not taught to think critically, we do not have the skills to immediately begin the process, or to carry out flow purification in a successful fashion. This does not mean we cannot develop the skills necessary. We can if we practice. It just means that at the start, we do not know what to do.

The second reason it can be difficult to engage in flow purification is because we often feel like we should not engage in critical examination of some of the ideas and archetypes in our brain. Why? Because many people are taught, by priests and gurus who tout “sacred” books, that the archetypes and ideas that were implanted in their brain when they were children are “sacred” in some way. They are the “word of God,” they are the sacred teachings of ancient rishis, and so on. As a consequence of the purported sacred nature of the archetypes, we feel we should not examine or touch them. This ten thousand year ruse, this idea that some ideas are sacred and should not be questioned or touched, keeps you from engaging in the flow purification necessary to improve and strengthen connection. This perspective, this position, this fear, if you have it, is misplaced. You have every right to question what a priest or guru says to you. You have every right to question the ideas and archetypes in your head. You have every right to wilfully decide

which ideas you want to think with and which archetypes you wish to filter your world experience with. If you want to move forward, you have to claim that right.

Finally, the **third** reason that flow purification can be a challenge is because the archetypes and ideas in your head that disconnect you and corrupt the flow are complicated, deeply buried, subtle, and seductive, particularly when the bodily ego is severely damaged. Even if you have developed the skill to begin sorting it out, even if you get over the nonsense about “sacred” ideas, it is still hard to sort it all out and make progress because of how complicated and confusing it can be. It is an understatement to say that there are many traps, pitfalls, and swindles put in your way to divert you from finding and achieving authentic and persistent connection.

In order to help sort things out and get you started on flow purification, the LP has developed the **Triumph of Spirit Archetype System** (TOSAS). As already noted, the TOSAS consists of a series of New Energy Archetype cards, along with a series of commentaries and (eventually) videos that can help you explore the archetypes in your brain, with the goal of purifying and strengthening the Flow. The TOSAS is introduced in the next LP workbook, *LP Workbook Four*. When you have completed this workbook, and when feel ready to move on, begin your Flow Purification with *LP Workbook Four*.

Discipline

And that brings us to end of this unit. Before closing, I want to emphasize the need to be disciplined in your connection practice. If you want to make progress towards stronger and more persistent connection, you are going to have to be disciplined. Being disciplined means engaging in connection practice in a disciplined, ideally daily, manner. Disciplined connection practice is important for the same reason that guitar practice is important, or any type of practice is important; it is the only way you make progress forward. If you want to make progress, if you want to stay healthy and alive, connection is something you need to achieve often, ideally every day. We are meant to be more connected. Our bodies are evolved to be connected full time. The only reason we are not more connected right now is because a) our societies, which are geared towards exploiting the masses, do not support connection and b) the violence and trauma of our childhood, adolescence, and adulthood traumatizes our bodily ego and causes it to restrict and shut down connection. If it was not for those things, we would find it easier to be connected more often. Because of those things, we have to work hard to bring disciplined practice to our own live. So how do you bring discipline to your life? There are a few things you can do. One, impose some structure on your life. Life

structure means essentially having certain routines. Go to sleep at the same time every night. Wake up at the same time. Engage in activities in a structured fashion. **Structure means routine so establish some life routines.**

Structure can help with connection practice for several reasons. One, life structure brings **energetic efficiency**. Having a structured day reduces time and energy use and increases focus and productivity in everything you do, not just connection. If you do not have to figure things out every day anew, if you can settle into easy routines, you will save time and energy. If you do this, you are more likely to get what needs to be done, done. It is like having a place for your tools, art supplies, kitchen implements, etc., and always putting your tools back in their place when you are done. When you do that, you **do not** waste time and energy looking for your tools when you need them. You know where they are. You grab them. You get the job done. It is the same thing when structuring your day. When your day has structure, you spend less time and energy seeking about trying to figure things out, less time on the job, and more time for everything else.

For two, structure helps you develop connection because structure encourages and **supports discipline**. Having a solid life structure gives you the space, time, and routine to practice things, like connection, or an instrument, every day. The routines you build are like train tracks that keep your energy and actions focused along the same lines. If you have structure and routines, if every day you sit down after supper and practice connection, or if every day you get up in the morning, connect, and write, the tracks you lay make it easier to sit down every day to practice. It is a question of simple habit. Develop the habit, lay the tracks, create the structure, and things flow in regular and controlled

directions.

Speaking of controlling direction, **the third reason** for having solid life structure is that having solid life structure helps improve control of your connection by reducing complexity and uncertainty. Reducing complexity and uncertainty are important because reducing complexity and uncertainty allows you to reduce mental and emotional distraction and distress, and focus energy in on controlling the expansion/acceleration of consciousness that occurs when you make strong connections. It works like this. If every day is a different day, if every day you are exposed to new things, new people, and new intellectual, emotional, and spiritual influences, you add complexity and uncertainty to your life. This complexity and uncertainty, while interesting, can bleed into your connection practice and make control harder to establish. This is especially true if the influences and experiences that come through in your unstructured life are not conducive to, or even hostile towards, connection. The sad truth is, many people on this planet are either confused about spirituality or actually hostile to your expanding connection. Those that are confused, confuse you. Those that are hostile to connection work deliberately to sow doubt, fear, hatred, and panic, so you cannot connect. Exposing yourself to these confused, chaotic, and hostile influences undermines your connection practice, especially at the beginning. Having life structure gives you the tools you need to keep them out. Having solid life structure makes it a lot easier to avoid negative influences. It limits your exposure to “new things” and gives you excuses for skipping out of the toxic life show. This ability of structure to provide you an “out” is important and is part of the **fourth reason** that structure

is important, and that is because structure facilitates the construction of boundaries. Boundaries allow you to keep people away from your private, connection spaces because when you structure your connection practice you can say things like, “this is my sacred space and sacred time, so please leave me alone.”

Being able to establish boundaries like this is extremely important, especially in the beginning stages of your practice, because boundaries help you reduce the frequency and unpredictability of **Negative Energy**

Insertions (NEIs).⁷⁹ Negative Energy Insertions are insertions of negative energy into your life space. When somebody freaks out at you in a road rage incident, when your boss at work yells at you, when your spouse lies to you, when somebody tries to feed you negative spiritual ideology (e.g., tall tales of hell and damnation), when you watch a super violent Hollywood movie, when your political leaders incite hatred and violence, etc., negative energy is inserted into your life space. NEIs are anathema to the health, well being, and connection of your physical unit. Like wrong thought, NEIs can contribute to nadir experiences and can disconnect you. For these reasons, it is important to reduce the frequency and unpredictability of negative energy insertions. Reducing NEIs by establishing structure and boundaries helps with connection, reduces damage, and frees up energy otherwise wasted in perpetual defence. Reducing and eliminating NEIs also makes it easier to defend the integrity and purity of your intellectual and life spaces and to put your energy where it is needed most.

It is like the front door of your house. Your house is a structure and the walls and doors of the structure are the boundaries of that structure.

Your house provides structures and these structures help protect you

⁷⁹https://spiritwiki.lightningpath.org/index.php/Negative_Energy_Insertion

and your family against NEIs. A front door on your house prevents random strangers from walking into your home. A front door keeps animals and bugs out. *A front door is a structural component of your home that reduces chaos and blocks against the entry of negativity*, if you use it properly. Of course, if you just throw your front doors open and let anything and anyone come inside, it **will not** protect you or your family from anything. If you are going to benefit from the structure and boundary of your home, you have to be sensible about who you open the door to. The structure of your home will not help **one** iota if you do not sensibly enforce the boundaries.

Study Questions

1. What is ascension? What are the four components of ascension identified in this chapter?
2. Briefly describe connection practice. What are the two components of connection practice?
3. List three things you can do to help open a wider connection.
4. Browse the SpiritWiki entry on [connection techniques](#). Pick one, research one, try it for yourself, and then, in 400 words or less, share what you learned. What books did you read to investigate. How do you practice it? Did it help you connect.
5. What are three reasons the LP recommends the use of connection supplements to open connection? Do you agree or disagree with these reasons?
6. Briefly describe the LP practices of flow control and flow purification. What is the TOSAS? How is this related to

flow purification?

7. As noted, structure and discipline are key. List the five ways structure are important to your connection practice. Examine structure and discipline in your life. Do you have enough structure and discipline? If not, what can you do to get some more structure?

Conclusion

In this workbook, we have looked at the Lightning Path Connection Framework. This framework provides a set of six focus points which you can use prepare and facilitate connection. These focus points are awakening, accountability, atonement, alignment, activation, and ascension. To prepare for connection, awaken to reality, become accountable for the damage you have caused, atone (make things right), align with your **spiritual ego** so you can activate and ascend (i.e. merge/achieve union) with your bright and powerful **spiritual ego**.

Sounds easy, perhaps, but as you can see after reading this workbook, there is a fair amount of work and there there are significant challenges. Even simply awakening to truth can be a major challenge, especially if you come from a toxic family background where your family works to suppress awareness and action. Still, you have to do it. Attaining a stronger connection with your own HS is the Holy Grail of authentic spirituality. It is the point and purpose of being incarnated in a human body.

So, what is next?

What is next, as already noted, is **flow purification**. To move forward, you have to actually practice connection and, as your connection **expands**, you have to practice and purify your connection by purifying out wrong thought and replacing it with right thought. *Lightning Path Workbook Four* helps you with flow purification. Using the powerful **Triumph of Spirit Archetype System (TOSAS)**, we will take you step by step through a process of **flow purification** that will you clean out

and replace old energy archetypes that block and disconnect,
with new energy archetypes that enhance and purify so you can
attain a strong and pure flow.

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